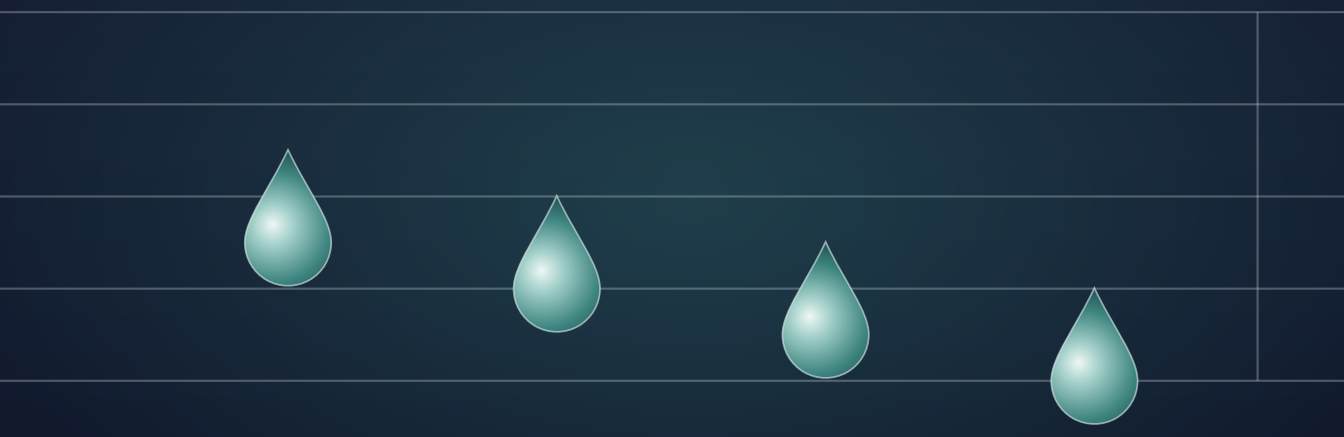
Lachrimae Verae

Lacrimal Anagnorisis and the Counter-Archive of Tears in Philip K. Dick's *Flow My Tears, the Policeman Said*



A dissertation

October 2026



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Abstract

This dissertation argues that Philip K. Dick's *Flow My Tears, the Policeman Said* (1974), conventionally read as a parable of ontological uncertainty, is more exactly a treatise on *attestation*: on the procedures by which a society certifies that a person is real, and on the catastrophe that follows when those procedures are monopolized by an archive of control. Jason Taverner, a genetically engineered entertainer whose existence is sustained by the gaze of thirty million viewers, awakens into a police state in which he has never existed. His ordeal exposes what I term the *documentary ontology* of the security state, a regime in which Berkeley's *esse est percipi* has been bureaucratized into *esse est inscribi*: to be is to be recorded.

Against this regime the novel elaborates, through the grief of Police General Felix Buckman and the wordless gift he extends to a Black stranger at an all-night service station, an alternative economy of recognition that I designate *lacrimal anagnorisis*: recognition effected not through tokens but through tears. Reconstructing the genealogy of this opposition, from Plato's interdiction of lament among the guardians of the *Republic* and Aristotle's taxonomy of recognition in the *Poetics*, through Gnostic soteriology, the Acts of the Apostles, Augustinian *caritas*, Lockean forensic personhood, Tudor political theology, Schopenhauer's metaphysics of compassion, and the twentieth-century critique of the archive in Arendt, Foucault, Derrida, and Agamben, and situating the novel among cognate fictions by Homer, Shakespeare, Carroll, Gogol, Pirandello, Kafka, Zamyatin, Orwell, Borges, Nabokov, Lem, and Le Guin, the dissertation advances four claims.

First, Dick inverts the Gnostic myth of the forgetful soul: in the *Hymn of the Pearl* the self forgets and the cosmos remembers; in *Flow My Tears* the self remembers and the cosmos forgets. Second, the drug KR-3 allegorizes totalitarianism as the pharmacological imposition of a private world (*idios kosmos*) upon the common one (*koinos kosmos*), a counterfeit of the compassionate dissolution of individuation that Schopenhauer placed at the root of ethics. Third, the novel organizes its erotic typology, from parasitism through narcissism, endogamy, and elegy, as an ascending ladder whose summit is an exogamous gift to the most radically other. Fourth, and decisively, the novel locates its counter-power not in the victim but in the apparatus: it is the *policeman* who weeps.

The argument culminates in a formula, *fleo, ergo es* ("I weep, therefore you are"), which displaces the Cartesian cogito with a second-person ontology grounded in ac-

knowledgment rather than verification. Tested against the strongest objections to sentimental ethics, namely Kundera's "second tear," Baldwin's indictment of the sentimentalist, and Morrison's critique of the Africanist presence in white American fiction, the formula survives only in qualified form: the tear is a threshold of justice, never its substitute. The Psalmist's image of tears preserved in a divine bottle and book (Ps. 56:8) supplies the figure for a *counter-archive* that records in order to mourn rather than to govern. Structurally, the dissertation is modelled on John Dowland's *Lachrimae, or Seaven Teares* (1604), whose seven pavans furnish the titles and the modal logic of its seven chapters.

Flow, my tears, fall from your springs!
Exiled for ever, let me mourn;
Where night's black bird her sad infamy sings,
There let me live forlorn.

John Dowland, *The Second Booke of Songs or Ayres* (1600)

Thou tellest my wanderings: put thou my tears into thy bottle: are they not in thy book?

Psalm 56:8 (Authorized Version)

"If I wasn't real," Alice said, half-laughing through her tears, it all seemed so ridiculous, "I shouldn't be able to cry."
"I hope you don't suppose those are real tears?" Tweedledum interrupted in a tone of great contempt.

Lewis Carroll, *Through the Looking-Glass* (1871), ch. 4

Note on Texts, Citation, and Terminology

References to *Flow My Tears, the Policeman Said* (Garden City, NY: Doubleday, 1974) are given by narrative episode rather than pagination, owing to the divergence of paginations across its many reissues; the novel is paraphrased rather than quoted. Classical texts are cited by standard numeration (Stephanus, Bekker, Diels-Kranz). Biblical citations follow the Authorized (King James) Version unless otherwise noted. Translations not otherwise attributed are my own.

Five terms of art recur. *Documentary ontology* designates any regime in which the conditions of social existence coincide with the conditions of inscription (*esse est inscribi*). *Atechnic recognition* designates recognition by tokens, which Aristotle ranks as the least artistic form of anagnorisis (*Poetics* 1454b20). *Lacrimal anagnorisis* designates recognition effected through memory and grief, of which Aristotle's paradigm is Odysseus weeping at the Phaeacian court (1455a2–4). *Dacryology*, borrowed from ophthalmology, where it denotes the study of the lacrimal apparatus, is reassigned here to the theory of tears as a mode of attestation. The *counter-archive* is any record kept in order to mourn rather than to govern.

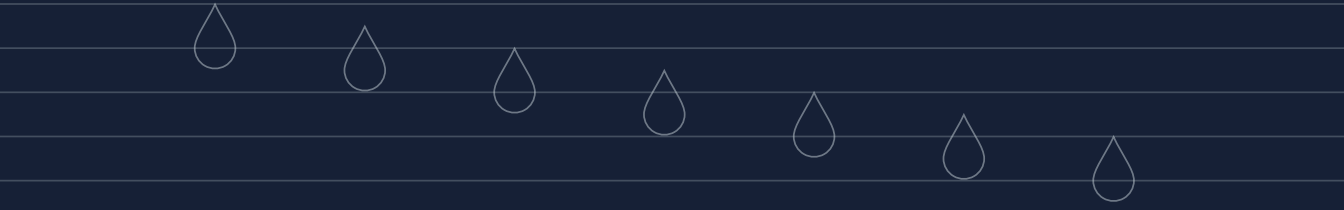
Prelude

Pavan

Flow, my tears, fall from your springs!

Dowland, The Second Booke of Songs or Ayres *(1600)*

The Grammar of a Lament



0.1 *The Speech-Tag of the State*

The title of Dick's novel is a sentence, and its grammar is an argument. A line of Elizabethan lament, the incipit of Dowland's most celebrated ayre, is placed within quotation and assigned by a narrative speech-tag not to a person but to a function: *the policeman said*. The attribution is anomalous on three counts. It transfers the lyric "I" of the lute-song, a voice of exile and erotic disgrace, into the mouth of the institution that administers exile. It converts an imperative addressed to one's own eyes into a reported utterance, an item in a record. And it confers upon the state, in the person of its enforcer, the one faculty that the founding text of Western political philosophy most explicitly denied to its guardians.

In Book III of the *Republic*, Socrates proposes "getting rid of the lamentations of famous men," handing them over to women and to "men of a baser sort," so that those educated as the city's defenders "may scorn to do the like" (387e–388a, trans. Jowett). The Achilles who lies now on his side, now on his back, now prone, pouring ash upon his head, is to be expunged; so is the Priam who grovels in supplication (388a–b). The class thus forbidden to weep is the class of *phylakes*, literally the watchmen: the police of the ideal city. Dick's title restores precisely what Plato censored, a guardian who weeps. This dissertation takes that restoration as its point of departure. It argues that the whole architecture of the novel, its metaphysical premise, its political anatomy, its erotic typology, and its theological dénouement, is organized around a question the title poses grammatically before the narrative poses it dramatically: *what does it mean for the law to weep?*

The premise is quickly stated. In 1988, in a United States reconstituted after a Second Civil War as a federation of checkpoints patrolled by "pols" and "nats," Jason Taverner is forty-two, a "six" (the product of a clandestine eugenic program), and host of a variety program commanding thirty million viewers. A discarded protégée, Marilyn Mason, assaults him with a Callisto cuddle sponge, a parasitic organism that roots its feeding tubes in his chest. He loses consciousness in hospital and wakes in a Watts hotel room without identification, in a world where no record, acquaintance, or medium retains any trace of him. In a polity that consigns the undocumented to forced-labor camps, this erasure is not a metaphysical curiosity but a sentence.

Taverner buys forged papers from Kathy Nelson, a nineteen-year-old forger who is also a police informant, and falls under the scrutiny of her handler, Inspector McNulty. He seeks shelter with Ruth Rae, a much-married woman in Las Vegas whose meditation on love and grief forms the novel's ethical center of gravity. He is drawn at last into

the household of Police General Felix Buckman and his twin sister Alys, whose incestuous union the novel treats with neither prurience nor condemnation. Alys, it emerges, has been taking KR-3, a drug that disorders the brain's construction of space and draws other persons into the user's configuration of the world. Taverner's erasure is the collateral effect of his inclusion, as an object of her attention, in her drug-sustained alternative.

When Alys dies, her corpse presenting to Taverner as a desiccated skeleton, his world reasserts itself and his records return. The apparatus, needing a culprit, resolves with Buckman's assent to charge Taverner with her death. Yet the novel's climax is not this resolution but its aftermath. Buckman, grief-stricken, flies through the night and alights at an all-night service station. He draws a heart pierced by an arrow on a scrap of paper and gives it to a Black stranger, and the two men embrace. The stranger belongs to a people whom the regime has reduced nearly to extinction by a law permitting each Black couple a single child: a genocide by the prevention of births. An epilogue then disposes of the principals in the flat diction of an actuarial register.

0.2 *From Ontology to Attestation*

Criticism has read this narrative chiefly through the dyad Dick canonized in his late lectures: *What is reality?* and *What is an authentic human being?* Three strands may be distinguished.

The first, ontological strand runs from Darko Suvin's foundational survey in *Science Fiction Studies* (1975), which located Dick's opus in a dialectic of artifice and refuge, through Kim Stanley Robinson's *The Novels of Philip K. Dick* (1984) and Patricia Warrick's *Mind in Motion* (1987), to Christopher Palmer's *Exhilaration and Terror of the Postmodern* (2003) and Umberto Rossi's *The Twisted Worlds of Philip K. Dick* (2011). This strand reads *Flow My Tears* as one more instance of the "ontologically uncertain" novel. The second, theological strand, comprising Lawrence Sutin's biography *Divine Invasions* (1989), Gabriel Mckee's study of Dick's science-fictional religion (2004), Erik Davis's *High Weirdness* (2019), and the editorial apparatus of *The Exegesis of Philip K. Dick* (2011), reads the novel retrospectively from the visionary experiences of February and March 1974. The third, postmodern strand begins with Baudrillard's appropriation of Dick in *Simulacres et simulation* (1981) and continues in Fredric Jameson, N. Katherine Hayles, and Scott Bukatman, enlisting Dick as a prophet of the simulacrum.

The present study departs from all three. The decisive problem of *Flow My Tears* is not whether Taverner's world is real. The novel answers that question with near-clinical explicitness in its laboratory exposition of KR-3, and it is among the few Dick novels

whose metaphysical premise is fully explained. The decisive problem is how *anyone* is certified as real within a world, and by whom. I call this the problem of *attestation*. It differs from the ontological problem as testimony differs from being: one may exist without being attested, and one may be attested without existing (the dead souls on Gogol's census rolls). The novel's horror lies in the gap between the two, and its hope lies in a mode of attestation that the security state cannot administer.

0.3 *The Thesis*

The thesis is that *Flow My Tears* stages a contest between two regimes of attestation. The *documentary* regime certifies persons through tokens: identity cards, police files, the broadcast image. Its formula is *esse est inscribi*, its epistemology is verification, and its paradigm is the checkpoint. The *lacrimal* regime certifies persons through grief: the involuntary, non-transferable, non-archivable testimony of one person's tears for another. Its formula is *fleo, ergo es*, its epistemology is acknowledgment, and its paradigm is the embrace at the service station.

The novel's genius lies in where it places the second regime. It is not lodged in the victim, whose tears would merely confirm his own existence, as Alice's do in Carroll's scene. It is lodged in the apparatus: the policeman who has just consented to frame an innocent man becomes the bearer of the tear. The law weeps, and in weeping it attests to a reality it cannot record.

The thesis is bold in its claims and qualified in its conclusion. Tears can be forced, performed, or savored, and the novel knows it. Its entertainers are professional purveyors of affect; its police general's tears follow, and do not undo, his complicity. Chapter VII therefore tests the lacrimal regime against its most serious critics and concludes that the tear is a threshold rather than a terminus: the first act of acknowledgment, which justice must complete.

0.4 *Circumstances of Composition, 1970–1974*

The novel was drafted in 1970 in Marin County as Dick's fourth marriage disintegrated. It was revised in 1973 in Fullerton, after the catastrophes of 1971–72: the unsolved burglary of his house in November 1971, his flight to Vancouver, a suicide attempt, and a residence in the X-Kalay rehabilitation program. Doubleday published it in early 1974, weeks before the experiences Dick would date "2-3-74" and spend the remainder of his life interpreting. It received the John W. Campbell Memorial Award in 1975 and was shortlisted for the Hugo and Nebula Awards.

Its composition coincides with the killing of four students by Ohio National Guardsmen at Kent State on 4 May 1970 and of two young men by city and state police at Jackson State eleven days later; with the disclosure in 1971, after activists burgled an FBI field office in Media, Pennsylvania, of COINTELPRO, the Bureau's covert program to surveil, infiltrate, and disrupt domestic political groups; and with Watergate (1972–74). Its publication coincides with the Paris appearance of the first volume of Solzhenitsyn's *Arkhipelag GULag* (December 1973). The coincidence is more than contextual. The "nats" who besiege the novel's subterranean universities are the National Guardsmen of Kent State, and the forced-labor camps are the archipelago whose first map was being published as Dick revised.

A biographical irony belongs here too. In the same years Dick corresponded with the FBI, and in 1974 he sent the Bureau a notorious letter denouncing Stanisław Lem, who had just praised him in print, as a front for a Communist committee. The author of a novel whose forger informs on her clients was himself, intermittently, an informant. The novel's sympathy for Kathy Nelson, compromised and frightened, is not the sympathy of an outsider.

In a 1978 lecture-essay, "How to Build a Universe That Doesn't Fall Apart Two Days Later," Dick claimed that the novel had unconsciously reproduced episodes from the Acts of the Apostles. Buckman's encounter with the Black stranger transposes Philip's encounter with the Ethiopian eunuch on the desert road to Gaza (Acts 8:26–40), and the name Felix recalls the Roman procurator Antonius Felix, before whom Paul was tried (Acts 24). Dick drew from this the conclusion that linear time is counterfeit and that the apostolic age persists beneath the present; the conclusion later hardened into the *VALIS* formula that "the Empire never ended." This dissertation takes the typology more seriously than its author did, and extends it further than he noticed.

0.5 *Architecture: Seven Tears in Five Parts*

Dowland's *Lachrimae, or Seaven Teares Figured in Seaven Passionate Pavans* (1604) varies a single descending figure, the falling minor tetrachord A–G–F–E that musicologists hear as the musical sign of a falling tear, across seven pavans for five viols and lute. The titles trace an itinerary: *Lachrimae Antiquae* (old tears), *Antiquae Novae* (old tears renewed), *Gementes* (groaning tears), *Tristes* (sad tears), *Coactae* (forced tears), *Amantis* (a lover's tears), and *Verae* (true tears).

The dissertation adopts this sequence as method, not ornament. Like Dowland's set, the argument varies a single figure, the tear as attestation, across seven registers.

Like Dowland's five-part texture, it treats the tear as polyphonic and never reducible to a single voice. Chapter I traces the ancient archive of recognition and forgetting. Chapter II reconstructs the modern documentary ontology. Chapter III reads KR-3 as an allegory of totalitarianism. Chapter IV anatomizes the novel's species of love. Chapter V examines the police state as a regime of forced affect. Chapter VI turns to the incestuous twins and the economy of the gift. Chapter VII interprets the service-station embrace and formulates the lacrimal cogito. A coda in the form of a galliard, the quick dance that conventionally followed the pavan, extends the argument to the documentary regimes of the present.

Chapter I

I

Lachrimae Antiquae

Old tears

The Ancient Archive of Recognition



The ancient world bequeathed to Dick not one theory of recognition but two, and the drama of *Flow My Tears* is generated by their collision. The first locates identity in tokens: marks, scars, rings, tallies, and passwords, things that can be shown, lent, stolen, forged, or lost. The second locates identity in the involuntary manifestation of memory, paradigmatically in tears, which cannot be possessed and therefore cannot be transferred. This chapter reconstructs the ancient archive of both and shows that the novel inverts each of its founding scenes.

1.1 *Aristotle's Ladder*

In the eleventh chapter of the *Poetics*, Aristotle defines *anagnorisis* as a change from ignorance to knowledge, issuing in friendship or enmity among those marked out for good or ill fortune (1452a29–32). Two features of the definition govern what follows. Recognition is relational: it terminates not in a proposition about a person but in *philia* or *echthra*, a reconfiguration of the bonds between persons. And it is a change in the recognizer rather than a property of the recognized: no one is recognizable in himself, only for another.

The sixteenth chapter ranks the species of recognition (1454b19–1455a21). Lowest stand recognitions by signs (*sēmeia*), whether congenital, acquired like scars, or external like necklaces; Aristotle calls this kind the least artistic and the most used, through poverty of invention (1454b20–21). Within it he discerns a further degradation. Signs displayed "for the sake of proof" (*pisteōs heneka*), as when Odysseus bares his scar to the herdsmen (*Od.* XXI.217–225), rank below signs disclosed by a turn of events, as when Eurycleia finds the same scar in the footbath (*Od.* XIX.386–475; *Poetics* 1454b25–30). Next come recognitions contrived by the poet, among them, in a phrase this dissertation will recall, "the voice of the shuttle" in Sophocles' lost *Tereus*: the tapestry through which Philomela, raped by her sister's husband Tereus and then silenced when he cut out her tongue, tells her sister what was done to her and by whom (1454b30–37). Third comes recognition through memory (*dia mnēmēs*), when a sight or sound awakens feeling: the hero of Dicaeogenes' *Cyprians* weeps at a painting, and Odysseus, hearing the Phaeacian bard, remembers and weeps, "and hence the recognition" (1454b37–1455a4). Fourth is recognition by inference, as in the *Choephori*; highest, recognition arising from the incidents themselves, as in *Oedipus* (1455a4–21).

The ladder ascends from exterior to interior and, more exactly, from the transferable to the non-transferable. A sign can be shown, lent, stolen, or described by an impostor; a scar is evidence that anyone who has heard of it can counterfeit in speech. Recognition by memory adds something categorically new: the token is no longer possessed but

undergone. Memory becomes visible as tears, which are not produced for proof but escape. It is not accidental that both of Aristotle's examples of the third species are lacrimal. The term *lacrimal anagnorisis* names nothing Aristotle failed to describe; it isolates what he failed to theorize, namely that the third species converts interiority into evidence precisely by its involuntariness.

Measured against this ladder, Dick's police state institutionalizes the lowest rung. Its recognitions are by signs, and its signs are always displayed for the sake of proof: the checkpoint universalizes the scene of the herdsmen, requiring every subject to bare the scar to every guard at every hour. The poverty of invention that Aristotle imputes to inferior poets becomes the charge the novel lays against the state. A polity able to recognize its members only by tokens is a bad poet, and its plots are correspondingly crude: arrest, detention, the labor camp.

1.2 *Nobody at Phaeacia*

The scene Aristotle names as the paradigm of recognition by memory repays reconstruction, because the novel inverts each of its elements. Demodocus sings the quarrel of Odysseus and Achilles; the unnamed guest draws his purple cloak over his head and weeps, concealing his tears from all but Alcinous, who, seated beside him, hears him groan (*Od.* VIII.73–95). Later, at the guest's own request, the bard sings the Wooden Horse, and the poem compares the weeping hero to a woman who throws herself on the body of her husband, fallen before his city, while the enemy beats her back and shoulders with spears and leads her into slavery (VIII.521–531). The sacker of cities weeps in the figure of the sacked.

Alcinous answers by asking the stranger's name, and his question contains what may be the earliest axiom of nominal personhood in Western literature: no one among men, base or noble, is wholly nameless (*anōnymos*), for parents give names to all at birth (VIII.550–554). He adds a theodicy of the archive: the gods spun ruin for the Achaeans so that there might be song for those yet to come (VIII.579–580). The guest replies with the most famous self-declaration in the poem: he is Odysseus, son of Laertes, known among men for his wiles, whose *kleos* reaches heaven (IX.19–20).

The scene has five moments. The stranger's memory is sung publicly by another; the song draws involuntary tears; the sovereign alone notices; the noticing occasions the demand for a name; the name is declared through a fame already in circulation. Every moment presupposes a common memory, the epic tradition as shared archive, of which Demodocus is the voice. Odysseus's tears are legible because the song is common.

Jason Taverner is a singer, and so occupies both positions: he is the Demodocus of his own *kleos* (the word means "what is heard," from *kluein*) and its hero. In the world into which he wakes, no Demodocus sings him, and Alcinous's axiom fails: a man can be wholly *anōnymos*. The novel nonetheless contains its own Phaeacian scene, displaced and degraded. After Alys Buckman's death, Taverner takes refuge in a café with the potter Mary Anne Dominic; a jukebox plays one of his records, and the patrons begin to know him. The restoration of the common world is announced not by a document but by a song, sung by a machine. And the song carries the novel's sharpest Homeric irony, for the hit that restores him is titled "Nowhere Nothin' Fuckup," which brands its singer not merely a nobody from nowhere but a failure and a disgrace (the infamy of §2.7). The *kleos* that returns Taverner to the world is the song of a nobody.

The irony has a precise antecedent. To the Cyclops, Odysseus gives his name as Nobody (*Outis*) (IX.364–367), and the pun linking *outis*, *mē tis*, and *mētis* (IX.405–414) makes namelessness the instrument of cunning. He narrates the episode at Phaeacia immediately after recovering his name through tears. The *Odyssey* thus knows namelessness as a weapon against a monster who cannot see what is not named. The documentary regime abolishes this option. It is not one-eyed but many-eyed, and for it "Nobody" is the most conspicuous name of all. The officials who take up Taverner's case read the totality of his absence from their data banks not as innocence but as information, and Buckman suspects it of concealing a conspiracy among the sixes. In the archive, the null set is a record.

1.3 *Argos and Argus*

The first being on Ithaca to recognize Odysseus is the dog Argos, lying neglected on a dung heap. Through twenty years and the disguise of a beggar he knows his master; he wags his tail and drops his ears, too weak to approach; Odysseus wipes away a tear, turning aside so that Eumaeus does not see; and the dog dies, having seen him (XVII.290–327). This is recognition without tokens, without speech, without memory articulated as song: the purest anagnorisis in the poem, answered by a hidden tear.

The same name belongs, in another myth, to the hundred-eyed watchman Argus Panoptes, whom Juno set over Io. In Ovid his head is ringed with a hundred "lights" (*centum luminibus*, *Met.* I.625). Mercury, disguised as a herdsman, lulls him to sleep with the reed-pipe and the story of its origin: the nymph Syrinx, changed into reeds through which the wind made a thin sound "like one lamenting" (*similemque*

querenti, I.708). Then he beheads him, and Juno sets the dead watchman's eyes in the peacock's tail (I.622–723).

The homonymy is an emblem of the two regimes this dissertation opposes. Argos the dog sees one man and recognizes him; Argus the watchman sees everything and recognizes no one. The panoptic watchman is disarmed only by a lament, and after his death his eyes become display: surveillance converted into spectacle, the watchman's gaze into the peacock's ornament. Bentham's *Panopticon* (1791) remythologized the watchman as architecture, and Foucault's *Surveiller et punir* (1975) narrated the historical passage from a society of spectacle to a society of surveillance. Dick's novel stages both phases of Ovid's myth simultaneously, a society of the checkpoint and the broadcast, of Argus's head and the peacock's tail; its protagonist is the man who falls from the tail into the gaze. That one of the regime's highest watchmen should end the novel in tears is the oldest of its inversions.

1.4 *The Inverted Pearl*

The *Hymn of the Pearl*, preserved in the Syriac *Acts of Thomas* (108–113), is the fullest narrative of Gnostic amnesia. A prince is stripped of his radiant robe and sent from the East into Egypt to retrieve the one pearl guarded by a serpent. He dons Egyptian garments lest he be suspected as one come from without; but the Egyptians perceive that he is not their countryman and give him their food, and he forgets that he is a king's son, serves their king, and sinks into sleep. His parents write a letter sealed by the great of the kingdom; it flies as an eagle, alights beside him, and becomes speech. He wakes, remembers, charms the serpent by naming his father's name, seizes the pearl, sheds the soiled garment, and returns, where his robe is sent out to meet him. In it he sees himself as in a mirror: two in distinction, and yet one in likeness.

Hans Jonas extracted the grammar of the myth: the alien, thrownness, the garment of the world, sleep and intoxication, the call from without, awakening, return (*The Gnostic Religion*, 1958, chs. 3 and 5). Its axiom is that the self forgets and the pleroma remembers, so that salvation is a message. Dick inverts every term. Taverner forgets nothing; the world forgets him. No letter descends; the only letters he obtains are bought from a forger who informs for the police. The disguise motif survives with uncanny exactness. Like the prince in his Egyptian garments, Taverner acquires forged cards in order to pass, and like the Egyptians, the regime perceives that he is not its countryman: the hotel clerk who leads him to the forger has already fixed a tracking device on him. But where the Egyptians feed the prince the food of forgetting, Dick's archons administer the drug not to the soul but to the world. The *pharmakon* circu-

lates in the bloodstream of the archon's own household, and the soul lies awake inside a sleeper's dream.

The robe of glory, the prince's heavenly double, is a garment that is also a mirror and a person, recognizing him as he recognizes it. Taverner's robe is his broadcast image, his double of light, and it has been withheld. One person alone in the alternative world knows him, and she knows only the robe. Alys Buckman tells him she knows he is a television star and produces copies of his records; the coroner will later establish that her devotion to him, under KR-3, is what carried him across. The only recognition available to Taverner is the fan's, which knows the image and possesses the man. In Gnostic terms, the demiurge alone knows the soul, and her knowledge is captivity.

The *Gospel of Thomas* promises that those who come to know themselves will become known (logion 3). Every page of Dick's novel refutes the promise: Taverner knows himself perfectly, and his self-knowledge, unshared, is worth nothing. The provenance of the *Hymn* sharpens the irony. It is preserved in the *Acts* of Judas Thomas, called the Twin (*Didymos*), and in the Fourth Gospel the Twin is the apostle who demands tokens: unless he sees the print of the nails and puts his hand into the wounded side, he will not believe (John 20:25). The risen Christ offers the wounds and blesses those who believe without seeing (20:27–29). The Twin is thus the patron at once of gnosis and of verification, of the robe that mirrors and the wound that proves. Dick divides these two Thomasine powers between his own twins (Chapter VI).

The sixes complete the parody. Valentinian teaching divided humanity into pneumatics, psychics, and hylics (Irenaeus, *Adv. Haer.* I.5–7); Sethian texts speak of an "immovable race" hidden among mortals. Dick's sixes are an elect manufactured by a secret government program four decades before the action: a pneumatic race by eugenic design, conscious of its election, whose election avails nothing once the world withdraws its gaze. The prince of the *Hymn* recovers his royalty by naming his father. Taverner's true lineage, a clandestine laboratory, is precisely what cannot be pronounced at a checkpoint. Gnostic election saves by knowledge; Dick's cannot save, because salvation in his world is a function not of what one knows but of what is known about one.

1.5 *Archontic Passwords*

The literature of Gnostic ascent turns the cosmos into a sequence of checkpoints. Origen preserves the Ophite formulas with which the soul addresses Ialdabaoth and his fellow rulers, bearing a token stamped with the image of life (*Contra Celsum* VI.31). In the *First Apocalypse of James* (NHC V,3), toll collectors seize the ascending soul and ask who it is and whence it comes; the prescribed answer is that it is a son and comes from

the Father. In the *Gospel of Mary* (BG 8502), the soul passes the powers in turn, and when Desire claims it, the soul replies that Desire saw it but did not recognize it, though it served Desire as a garment.

The Orphic gold tablets of Hipponion (c. 400 BCE) and Petelia instruct the dead to avoid the first spring they meet and to seek the cold water flowing from the lake of Memory. Guardians stand before it and will ask the traveller's purpose; the password is a declaration of lineage: I am a child of Earth and starry Heaven, but my race is heavenly. The guardians of Memory are *phylakes*, the word Plato uses for the guardians of his city.

Ascent literature thus furnishes the complete morphology of the checkpoint: gate, guardian, interrogation about origin, password. What distinguishes Dick's checkpoint is the epistemology of its password. In Orphic and Gnostic ascent, self-knowledge is the passport, and one passes by declaring what one truly is. In Dick's police state, the true declaration is a symptom. "I am Jason Taverner, whom thirty million watch" is, clinically, a delusion of grandeur, and only a forged lineage passes. The Gnostic soul escapes because the archon fails to recognize it; Taverner is endangered because the archons fail to recognize him. Non-recognition, once the soul's escape from the cosmos, has become the citizen's sentence.

The twentieth century had produced one Gnostic novel of the police state before Dick's. In Nabokov's *Invitation to a Beheading* (Russian 1935–36; English 1959), Cincinnatus C. is condemned, in a world of mutual transparency, for "gnostical turpitude," the crime of being opaque; at the end he walks out of the collapsing stage-set of the world toward beings akin to him. Taverner's opacity is of another order. It is not an inner depth the others cannot penetrate but an outer blank the files cannot fill, and it admits no exit, only the return of the old set.

The archons of the cosmos and the archons of the city converge in the word *archive*. Derrida recalls that the *arkheion* was the residence of the archons, the magistrates who commanded and who were "first of all the documents' guardians," and he calls the resulting authority the archontic principle; there is, he adds, no political power without control of the archive, if not of memory (*Mal d'archive*, 1995). The Gnostic archons guard the gates of the spheres; the Athenian archons guard the documents. Dick's pols do both. They staff the gates and keep the files, and the passwords they demand are documents.

1.6 *Lethe, Gyges, Actaeon*

Hesiod makes Lethe a child of Strife, born together with Toil, Famine, and "tearful Pains" (*Algea dakryoenta*, *Theog.* 226–227): forgetting and tears are siblings from the first. In the Myth of Er that closes the *Republic*, the souls march to the plain of Lethe and camp by the river Ameles, whose water no vessel can hold. All must drink a measure, the foolish drink more, and whoever drinks forgets everything; Er alone is forbidden to drink, and returns to tell. The dialogue closes on the remark that the tale was saved and did not perish, and that it will save us if we heed it (621a–c). The dialogue that banished lament from the city ends with a counter-archive: a tale rescued from oblivion by a witness who did not drink.

Taverner is an inverted Er. Er remembers the other world and returns to an audience prepared to listen; Taverner remembers his own world and finds himself among people who have, as it were, drunk. If Heidegger's reading of truth as *a-lētheia*, un-concealment, is followed ("Platons Lehre von der Wahrheit," 1942; the *Parmenides* lecture course of 1942–43), the world's truth about Taverner has been withdrawn into *lēthē*, not through his forgetting but through everyone else's. The clearing (*Lichtung*) in which beings stand unconcealed had been, for the entertainer, the literal light of the studio. When it goes out, he does not cease to be. He ceases to appear.

The Myth of Er contains a further scene that bears on the novel's moral question. Odysseus, drawing the last lot, has been cured of the love of honor (*philotimia*) by the memory of his toils; he searches long for the life of a private man who minds his own business (*bios andros idiōtou apragmonos*), finds it lying neglected in a corner, and chooses it gladly (620c–d). Plato's Odysseus is cured of *kleos* by remembered suffering. The question the novel puts to Taverner is whether a week of anonymity can effect the same cure: whether the six can choose the life of the *idiōtēs*. The same root, *idios*, names Plato's private life, which is wisdom, and Heraclitus's private world, which is sleep (§1.7). The epilogue answers through Heather Hart rather than Taverner: it is she who abandons celebrity for seclusion.

Plato's Gyges (*Rep.* II 359c–360d) finds a ring that renders him invisible, seduces the queen, kills the king, and takes the throne, and Glaucon asks whether anyone would remain just if unseen. In Herodotus's earlier version (I.8–12) there is no ring. Candaules shows Gyges his naked queen; she sees that she has been seen; Gyges must kill or die. The two versions establish two economies of vision, the immunity of the unseen and the violence of the seen, and Dick's state holds both. Its surveillance is Candaulean, a sovereignty that exhibits and inspects, and Taverner is a negative Gyges, invisible to the archive and for that very reason maximally visible at the checkpoint. The ring that hides its bearer from the record exposes him to the guard.

Modern fiction had already converted invisibility from license into affliction. Wells's Griffin (*The Invisible Man*, 1897) is naked, cold, betrayed by the food visible in his stomach, and becomes visible only as he dies. Ellison's narrator (*Invisible Man*, 1952) is invisible "simply because people refuse to see me," and lives underground beneath 1,369 stolen lights because light confirms his reality. Ellison's invisibility is social, inflicted along the color line. Taverner's week of invisibility is accordingly a white celebrity's brief sojourn in a condition that is constitutive and permanent for the novel's Black population, which the regime has driven to the edge of extinction. The novel's last movement takes place on that line (Chapter VII).

Ovid supplies the archetype of the documentary nightmare. Actaeon, the hunter who saw what he should not have seen, is changed into a stag. He tries to cry out and no voice follows; he groans, and that is his voice; tears run down a face not his own; only his former mind remains: *mens tantum pristina mansit* (*Met.* III.201–203). He longs to cry "*Actaeon ego sum: dominum cognoscite vestrum!*" ("I am Actaeon: know your master!"), but words fail him (III.230), and his own hounds tear him apart. His companions, urging on the pack, shout for Actaeon as though he were absent; he turns his head at his name; and they complain that he is missing the spectacle of the prey (III.242–246). The name circulates, the man is present, and the two never meet; the spectacle he is said to be missing is himself.

This is Taverner's condition with uncanny precision: a continuous mind within an unrecognized form, a self-declaration that cannot reach the pack, an apparatus turned against the man it served, and a name that circulates without attaching. The tear is the last trace of the person under metamorphosis, and the hounds do not read tears. Kafka renewed the figure in *Die Verwandlung* (1915). Gregor Samsa's voice degenerates into an animal squeak while his mind remains; drawn by his sister's violin, he wonders whether he was an animal, that music could move him so (*War er ein Tier, da ihn Musik so ergriff?*); and his sister then pronounces that "it" must go. He dies that night, the apple his father threw at him still lodged in his back: in Kafka, non-recognition is lethal, and the family administers it. The stag will return at the novel's close, transfigured: a police general whose very name contains the buck draws a pierced heart, the hart and the heart of the Elizabethan pun.

1.7 *Heraclitus: The Common World and Its Law*

Plutarch transmits the Heraclitean distinction on which Dick drew directly: for the waking there is one common world (*koinos kosmos*), while each sleeper turns aside into a private one (DK 22 B89). Cognate fragments sharpen it. The *logos* is common, yet the

many live as though they possessed a private understanding (*idian phronēsin*, B2); the many fail to notice what they do awake, just as they forget (*epilanthanontai*) what they do asleep (B1); one should not act and speak like sleepers (B73). Dick adopted the terms in two essays of the mid-1960s, "Drugs, Hallucinations, and the Quest for Reality" (1964) and "Schizophrenia & The Book of Changes" (1965), in which the *idios kosmos* is the schizophrenic's withdrawal from the shared world. *Flow My Tears* radicalizes the dichotomy by making it political. It asks what happens when an *idios kosmos* is administered as the *koinos*.

Heraclitus had already given the common world a juridical foundation. Those who speak with understanding (*xyn nōi*) must hold fast to what is common (*xynōi*) to all, as a city holds to its law, and far more firmly, for all human laws are nourished by one divine law (B114); the people must fight for the law as for their wall (B44). The common world is homologous with the city's *nomos*. The novel discloses the perverse completion of the homology: the *nomos* that now sustains the common world is the police archive, and the common world it sustains turns out (Chapter III) to be a sleeper's private one. The distinction between waking and sleeping collapses, not epistemically but administratively.

A philological coda belongs here. *Police* descends through Middle French and Late Latin *politia* from the Greek *politeia*, citizenship or constitution, which is also the title of the dialogue known in English as the *Republic*. The policeman of Dick's title is, by etymology, the man of the *politeia*: the guardian of the very dialogue that forbade its guardians to weep.

1.8 *The Inversion of Phaeacia*

The ancient archive of recognition presupposed a common memory capable of rendering tears legible: the epic song, the initiate's password, the city's law. The documentary regime replaces common memory with the file, and *Flow My Tears* stages the moment at which *kleos* is replaced by the dossier. Table 1 summarizes the inversions reconstructed in this chapter. One ancient structure survives, inverted at its center. At Phaeacia the stranger weeps and the king notices. At the close of Dick's novel the sovereign weeps, and the stranger receives.

Table 1. The ancient archive of recognition and its inversion in *Flow My Tears*

Paradigm	Source	Medium of recognition	Inversion in Dick
The bard at Phaeacia	*Od.* VIII.73–95, 521–586; IX.19–20	Tears provoked by a shared song, noticed by the king	No one sings him until a jukebox does; at the close the sovereign weeps and the stranger receives

Paradigm	Source	Medium of recognition	Inversion in Dick
Argos and Argus	*Od.* XVII.290–327; Ovid, *Met.* I.622–723	The dog's wordless knowledge; the watchman's hundred eyes	The many-eyed state sees all and knows no one; one of its watchmen ends in tears
Hymn of the Pearl	*Acts of Thomas* 108–113	A letter from above; the robe as mirror	The self remembers and the world forgets; the only letters are forgeries
Orphic and Gnostic ascent	Hipponion and Petelia tablets; *1 Apoc. Jas.*; *Gospel of Mary*	A password declaring true lineage	The true declaration sounds like delusion; only forged lineage passes
Myth of Er	Plato, *Rep.* X 620c–621c	A witness who did not drink	The witness is sober and the world has drunk; no one will hear the tale
Gyges	Plato, *Rep.* II 359c–360d; Herodotus I.8–12	Invisibility as license	Invisibility to the archive is exposure at the checkpoint
Actaeon	Ovid, *Met.* III.138–252	Tears on a face not his own, unread by his hounds	A continuous mind in an unrecognized form, hunted by his own apparatus
The sleepers	Heraclitus, DK 22 B1, B2, B89, B114	The common *logos*, held as a city holds its law	The common world is a sleeper's private world, enforced by police

Chapter II

II

Lachrimae Antiquae Novae

Old tears renewed

The Documentary Ontology



The ancient forms reconstructed in Chapter I, the token, the checkpoint, the interrogation of origin, and the book in which names are written, were renewed by the early modern and modern state as instruments of administration: old tears in new vessels. This chapter reconstructs the documentary ontology that *Flow My Tears* presupposes and exposes, and argues that Taverner's ordeal turns on the dissolution of a unity that early modern philosophy labored to construct, the unity of the conscious person and the forensic person.

2.1 *From Testimony to Document*

In 1560 the Parlement of Toulouse had to decide whether the man living as Martin Guerre in the village of Artigat was Martin Guerre. Some hundred and fifty witnesses divided, a plurality declining to decide, and the accused, Arnaud du Tilh, commanded intimate memories that only Martin should have possessed. The question was settled only when the true Martin returned on a wooden leg and was recognized by his sisters and his wife, in a scene Jean de Coras's *Arrest memorable* (1561) narrates through embraces and tears (Natalie Zemon Davis, *The Return of Martin Guerre*, 1983). The case marks the hinge between two regimes. In the older, identity was attested by kin and community, and memory could be counterfeited; in the newer, the state would seek tokens no impostor could learn.

Valentin Groebner's history of identification (*Der Schein der Person*, 2004; English *Who Are You?*, 2007) shows that the safe-conduct, the passport, the seal, and the written description arrived together with their counterfeits: every paper that certified a person created the possibility of its forgery. John Torpey (*The Invention of the Passport*, 2000) argues that modern states came to monopolize "the legitimate means of movement," as Weber's state monopolizes legitimate violence, and that to do so they had to "embrace" their populations in the sense of the German *erfassen*: to grasp, to register, to capture in a file. The metaphor should be held in reserve. Dick's novel ends with an embrace of an entirely different kind.

The nineteenth century fused the token with the body. Alphonse Bertillon's anthropometry, adopted by the Paris Prefecture of Police in the early 1880s, measured bones and standardized the frontal and profile photograph; Francis Galton's *Finger Prints* (1892) made the friction ridges of the fingertip a signature no one could forge. Carlo Ginzburg ("Spie," 1979) placed these techniques within an evidential paradigm for reading involuntary traces, and Allan Sekula ("The Body and the Archive," 1986) showed that the honorific portrait and the police photograph belonged to a single "shadow archive," organized by one logic of comparison. Taverner travels from one

pole of Sekula's archive to the other, from the honorific image to the precinct's biometric checks, and the journey exposes a principle the archive conceals. A fingerprint identifies only by comparison with a prior record: recognition is literally re-cognition, and an index without an archive is mute. Taverner's body is as unforgeable as ever, and it proves nothing.

The novel stages the consequence with deadpan precision. At the 469th Precinct, Inspector McNulty's search returns a "Jason Tavern," a diesel mechanic from Wyoming, and Taverner survives by consenting to the error, explaining the discrepancy of appearance as the work of plastic surgery. The database finds the tavern but not the taverner: the house without its host (§2.9). McNulty then issues him a seven-day police pass, a document exact in its ontology. The state licenses his existence for one week.

2.2 *The Forensic Person*

Locke's chapter "Of Identity and Diversity," added to the second edition of the *Essay* (1694), defines a person as a thinking being that "can consider itself as itself" in different times and places, and locates personal identity in the reach of consciousness backward into the past (II.xxvii.9). Its most famous thought experiment imagines the soul of a prince, carrying the consciousness of his princely life, entering the body of a cobbler: everyone, Locke says, would see that he was the same person as the prince, though not the same man (§15). By Locke's criterion Taverner remains wholly himself, his consciousness extending unbroken into the life the world has forgotten.

Locke also calls *person* a "forensic term," appropriating actions and their merit, which belongs only to agents capable of a law (§26). His theory thus unites two senses of personhood: the person as continuity of consciousness and the person as bearer of accountability. Dick's novel splits them. Taverner has the first without the second, Lockean consciousness without forensic existence.

Locke knew the seam along which the split would open. Asking why a man is punished for what he did when drunk and cannot remember, he concedes that human judicatures punish justly "because the fact is proved against him, but want of consciousness cannot be proved for him"; only at the Great Day, when the secrets of all hearts are laid open, will conscious and forensic personhood coincide (§22). The cobbler-prince of §15 is recognized because "every one sees," but everyone sees only from the standpoint of the Great Day. In any human court, a cobbler claiming the memories of a prince would be committed to Bedlam. *Flow My Tears* unfolds in the interval between human judicature and the Last Judgment, where Taverner's consciousness cannot be

proved for him, and where the regime charges him with a death, Alys Buckman's, of which he knows nothing (the epilogue records that he is cleared).

Derek Parfit later argued that personal identity is not what matters; what matters is psychological connectedness and continuity (*Reasons and Persons*, 1984). Dick's novel supplies a social corollary that Parfit's metaphysics does not address. Socially, what matters is neither identity nor continuity but attestation: the uptake of one's continuity by others.

2.3 *Persona and Leviathan*

The sixteenth chapter of Hobbes's *Leviathan* (1651) derives *person* from the Latin *persona*, the disguise or mask of the stage, and concludes that "a person is the same that an actor is, both on the stage and in common conversation." Natural persons own their words; artificial persons bear the words of others, by whom they are authorized. A multitude becomes one person when represented by one representer, for "it is the unity of the representer, not the unity of the represented, that maketh the person one."

The engraved frontispiece makes the theory visible: the sovereign's body is composed of hundreds of small subjects, turned inward to face him (Horst Bredekamp, *Thomas Hobbes Visuelle Strategien*, 1999). The image is also the prototype of an audience. Taverner the entertainer is a Leviathan of attention, an artificial person whose public body is composed of thirty million viewers turned toward him. When they turn away, the artificial person dissolves, and the natural man is left in a hotel room.

Max Weber identified the hinge of this condition when he wrote that recognition by those subject to authority is decisive for the validity of charisma (*Economy and Society*, Part One, ch. III, §10). The sixes push what Weber called the routinization of charisma to its biological limit: charisma engineered into the germ line. The novel refutes the project. Taverner's beauty, intelligence, and erotic magnetism survive the catastrophe intact, and they still open doors and beds. They cannot open a single file. Charisma is not in the genome but in the gaze.

Roman law had already registered the paradox of the performer. The praetor's edict branded with *infamia* anyone who appeared on the stage for pay (*Dig.* 3.2.1): the most famous men in Rome were legally infamous. Polybius describes how, at the funerals of the nobility, the wax masks (*imagines*) of the dead man's ancestors were worn by men chosen for their resemblance in stature and bearing (VI.53). The Roman *persona* was a funeral mask on the face of a stand-in, and aristocratic identity consisted in the right to such images. Giorgio Agamben ("Identity without the Person," in *Nudità*, 2009) traces the person from this mask of social recognition to Bertillon and Galton, arguing

that biometric identification produces an identity without the person: data about a body, detached from any recognition by others. Taverner's ordeal begins at the far end of Agamben's genealogy. His identity without the person has been deleted, and the novel asks whether a person without identity can survive.

The apparatus, too, wears masks. Buckman, interrogating Taverner, presents himself as a "seven," a rank of engineered superiority that does not exist. The police general forges a persona in order to examine a man accused of lacking one.

2.4 *The Celebrity's Two Bodies*

Ernst Kantorowicz (*The King's Two Bodies*, 1957) reconstructed the Tudor doctrine, recorded in Plowden's *Reports*, by which the king possesses a mortal body natural and an immortal body politic. Shakespeare's *Richard II* is, in Kantorowicz's reading, the tragedy of their separation. Sitting upon the ground, Richard tells sad stories of the death of kings and protests that he lives with bread, feels want, tastes grief, and needs friends like any subject (III.ii). Deposed, he declares that he has no name and no title, not even the name given him at the font; he wishes he were a mockery king of snow, to melt himself away in water-drops, which is to say to become his tears; he calls for a mirror, reads in it a face "bankrupt of his majesty," and dashes it to the ground: "A brittle glory shineth in this face; / As brittle as the glory is the face." When Bolingbroke observes that the shadow of his sorrow has destroyed the shadow of his face, Richard replies that the external manners of lament are merely shadows of the unseen grief that swells with silence in the tortured soul (IV.i).

The modern celebrity is a king of two bodies whose body politic is an image, and its mode of existence is reproduction. Benjamin observed that the cult of the film star preserves not the aura of the person but "the phony spell of a commodity" (1935–36). Daniel Boorstin defined the celebrity as "a person who is known for his well-knownness" (*The Image*, 1961). Guy Debord defined the spectacle as a social relation among people mediated by images, and the star as the spectacular representation of a living human being (*La Société du spectacle*, 1967, theses 4 and 60). Boorstin's tautology is the key to Taverner's catastrophe. If a celebrity is known for being known, the withdrawal of knownness leaves nothing to be known. Richard is deposed and keeps his face. Taverner is not deposed but unmade, and keeps only his face.

Lear poses the question in its starkest form. Rebuked by his daughter in her own house, he demands whether anyone there knows him, whether this is Lear who walks thus and speaks thus; either his notion weakens or his "discernings / Are lethargied," a

word that descends from Lethe. "Who is it that can tell me who I am?" The Fool answers, in the Folio text: "Lear's shadow" (I.iv).

What befalls Taverner is closer to a Roman practice than to a deposition. Under *damnatio memoriae*, as modern scholarship calls it, a disgraced emperor's name was chiseled from inscriptions and his face scraped from images; the Severan family tondo in Berlin still shows the blank where Geta stood. Harriet Flower (*The Art of Forgetting*, 2006) emphasizes the paradox of the practice: erasure memorializes, because the gap is conspicuous. So the gap Taverner leaves in the data banks is conspicuous to the police who examine it. Dowland had already written the lament of the fallen star: "Down vain lights, shine you no more!"; "Light doth but shame disclose"; "From the highest spire of contentment / My fortune is thrown."

2.5 *Esse est Inscribi*

Berkeley held that the *esse* of sensible things is *percipi* (*Principles of Human Knowledge*, 1710, §3), and his notebooks complete the formula: to exist is to be perceived or to perceive. The persistence of unperceived things he secured by an infinite percipient (*Three Dialogues*, 1713). Ronald Knox's limerick about the tree in the Quad, with its anonymous rejoinder signed by God, compressed the doctrine into a joke: the tree persists because God is always about in the Quad.

The documentary state retains Berkeley's structure and replaces its guarantor. The archive, not God, is always about in the Quad, and what it does not inscribe does not persist. The formula of documentary ontology is therefore *esse est inscribi*: to be is to be inscribed. Taverner still perceives, so by the second half of Berkeley's formula he remains a spirit; but no record perceives him, and in the order of things that matter to the state he is nothing. Borges imagined the consequences in "Tlön, Uqbar, Orbis Tertius" (1940): on that planet of congenital idealists, forgotten things grow vague and lose their details, and a doorway survives only so long as a beggar keeps visiting it.

The secularized archive inherits a theological prototype. Moses asks to be blotted out of God's book if Israel is not forgiven (Exod. 32:32–33); the Psalmist prays that the wicked be blotted out of the book of the living (Ps. 69:28); and at the Last Judgment the books are opened, and whoever is not found written in the book of life is cast into the lake of fire (Rev. 20:12, 15). The forced-labor camp is the lake of fire bureaucratized, and Taverner is the man not found written. Yet the same canon preserves a book of another kind. The Psalmist asks God to put his tears into a bottle, and asks whether they are not already in God's book (Ps. 56:8). The book of life records names; this book

records tears. The Coda will argue that the novel gropes toward a counter-archive of exactly this kind.

2.6 *The Paperless Man*

Flow My Tears belongs to a modern genealogy of figures reduced to bare life by the loss of documents. Gogol's "The Nose" (1836) imagines the part outranking the whole: Major Kovalyov's nose parades through Petersburg in the uniform of a State Councillor, a rank above its owner's. *Dead Souls* (1842) inverts the problem, as Chichikov buys serfs who are dead but still alive on the census rolls: persons on paper without persons in life. Pirandello's *Il fu Mattia Pascal* (1904) gives the classic modern form. Declared dead by mistake, Mattia takes a new name and discovers that freedom without civil status is impotence: he can neither marry nor report a theft, and he ends as the late Mattia Pascal, laying flowers on his own grave. Pirandello's later title, *Uno, nessuno e centomila* (1926), could serve as the formula of Taverner's descent, from thirty million to no one.

Kafka's *Das Schloss* (1926) sets a man whose summons is neither confirmed nor denied against an infinitely documented authority, whose secretary Momus wants only to take down K.'s protocol. B. Traven's *Das Totenschiff* (1926) follows an American sailor who loses his papers in Antwerp, is disowned by every consulate, and ends aboard a ship crewed by the undocumented, a floating labor camp. Orwell's *Nineteen Eighty-Four* (1949) names the condition. The vaporized man becomes an "unperson" who has never existed, while Winston Smith, a forger at the Ministry of Truth, invents a Comrade Ogilvy whose existence is thereafter as well attested as anyone's. Kathy Nelson is the novel's Winston: a forger whose fabrications are commissioned and monitored by the police.

Hannah Arendt supplied the theory. The stateless, she argued, had lost not particular rights but "the right to have rights," a place in the world that makes opinions significant and actions effective, and the world had found nothing sacred in the abstract nakedness of being human (*The Origins of Totalitarianism*, 1951, ch. 9). Her bitterest criterion applies to Taverner exactly. To decide whether someone has been forced outside the pale of the law, ask whether he would benefit from committing a crime: for the stateless person, only as an offender can he gain the law's protection. Taverner acquires existence by becoming a suspect. The police file McNulty opens is the first record of him the new world produces that is not a forgery.

Table 2. The paperless person in modern fiction

Text	Relation of person to record	Outcome	Taverner's variation
Gogol, "The Nose" (1836)	A part outranks its owner	Farce	The image outranks the man, then vanishes
Gogol, *Dead Souls* (1842)	Records without persons	Fraud	A person without records
Pirandello, *Il fu Mattia Pascal* (1904)	A living man declared dead	Civil impotence; flowers on his own grave	Not declared dead but never born
Kafka, *Das Schloss* (1926)	A status neither confirmed nor denied	Endless petition	A status vividly remembered and nowhere recorded
Traven, *Das Totenschiff* (1926)	Papers lost, citizenship disowned	Forced labor at sea	Threatened with forced labor on land; escapes by forgery
Borges, "Tlön, Uqbar, Orbis Tertius" (1940)	Things persist only while remembered	Effacement	A man persists in his own memory alone
Orwell, *Nineteen Eighty-Four* (1949)	Persons erased, fictions inscribed	The unperson	Erased without a decree; a forger inscribes a real man

2.7 *Infamy*

Virgil's Fama grows as she goes, a monster with as many watchful eyes and tongues as feathers (*Aen.* IV.173–197). Ovid's House of Fama stands at the center of the world, open day and night, built of resounding bronze that repeats whatever it hears (*Met.* XII.39–63). Chaucer's *House of Fame* adds the arbitrariness of a goddess who grants and refuses renown without regard to desert. Classical Fame is already a broadcast medium, and Taverner was its creature.

Foucault's "La vie des hommes infâmes" (1977) describes obscure lives that survive in the archive of the *lettres de cachet* only because they once collided with power; what drew them from darkness was that encounter. Foucault's infamous men are infamous in the etymological sense, without *fama*. Taverner is a famous man made infamous in exactly this sense, who then exists in the new world only through his collisions with the police. Dowland's ayre, lines of which head the novel's divisions, has the word ready: "Where night's black bird her sad infamy sings."

J. L. Austin's *How to Do Things with Words* (1962) distinguished statements, which describe, from performatives, which do what they say: "I arrest you." In the documentary regime the policeman's word is the paradigmatic performative, since what he enters into the record becomes the case. The title's speech-tag, *the policeman said*, belongs to this order. Yet the sentence it reports is the one performative no policeman can enforce. "Flow, my tears" is an imperative addressed to one's own eyes, and tears cannot be commanded. Chapter V will argue that the novel turns on this infelicity: the single utterance of the state that cannot be made true by the state's saying it.

2.8 *Attestation and Acknowledgment*

Hegel's dialectic of lordship and bondage (*Phänomenologie des Geistes*, 1807, §§178–196) shows that the lord's self-certainty depends on recognition by a consciousness he does not recognize in return. The celebrity is a lord of this kind, sustained by an audience he does not know. Axel Honneth (*Kampf um Anerkennung*, 1992) distinguishes three spheres of recognition: love, rights, and social esteem. Taverner loses the second and third at a stroke, his papers and his fame, and spends the novel seeking the first from women who do not remember him.

Erving Goffman (*Stigma*, 1963) defined personal identity as the combination of "identity pegs," positive marks such as photograph and fingerprint, with the items of life history that attach to the individual by means of those pegs. Taverner has the life history and no pegs. Paul Ricoeur (*Soi-même comme un autre*, 1990) gave the name *attestation* to the specific certainty of selfhood: the assurance of being oneself acting and suffering, a credence without guarantee, occupying the ground between Descartes's exalted cogito and Nietzsche's shattered one. This dissertation borrows Ricoeur's term and contests its center of gravity. Taverner possesses Ricoeurian attestation intact, and the novel shows that self-attestation, absent attestation by another, is indistinguishable from delusion. A man who insists that he is a famous singer whom no one has heard of presents, from outside, as a textbook case of grandiosity; from inside, his situation resembles an inverted Capgras syndrome, in which the whole world appears replaced by unknowing doubles. The novel holds both perspectives at once, and the reader, who knows Taverner to be right, is placed in the position of a witness whose testimony no court will hear.

Two further distinctions prepare the argument of Chapter VII. Stanley Cavell ("Knowing and Acknowledging," 1969) argued that the problem of other minds is a failure not of knowledge but of acknowledgment: it is not enough to know that another suffers; one must do or reveal something in response. Derrida (*Demeure*, 1998) argued that testimony is irreducible to proof. To testify is to say "believe me," and a testimony that could be proven would cease to be testimony. Taverner's predicament can now be stated exactly. Everything he can offer is testimony, and the regime admits only proof. What the novel discovers is a form of attestation that is neither proof nor self-assurance: acknowledgment conferred by another's grief.

2.9 *Jason before the Politarchs*

Dick's lecture of 1978 dwells on Philip, the Ethiopian, and the procurator Felix. Whether or not he registered it, a third episode of Acts belongs to the same constella-

tion and bears directly on the documentary problem. In Thessalonica a mob, failing to find Paul and Silas, drags their host before the city's magistrates. The host's name is Jason. The magistrates are the *politarchai*, a title confirmed by inscriptions from the city. The charge is that Jason has received men who "have turned the world upside down," who act against the decrees of Caesar, saying that there is another king; and the magistrates release Jason only after taking "security" of him (Acts 17:5–9). The Jason of Acts is a host arraigned before the rulers of the *polis*, accused of harboring those who proclaim another king, and released upon a bond.

The onomastics of Dick's protagonist converge on this figure. The mythic Jason arrives at Iolcus wearing one sandal and is recognized by that sign as the man of the oracle (Pindar, *Pythian* 4); he seeks the Golden Fleece as the token that will legitimate his claim to his father's throne; and in Euripides, exiling Medea, he offers her *symbola*, tokens of guest-friendship to present to his hosts abroad, which she refuses with contempt (*Medea* 612–617). The *symbolon* was a tally broken in two, whose matching halves proved the bond between guest and host; it is also the word Aristophanes uses in the *Symposium* for each lover, the half that seeks its matching half (191d), a convergence Chapter VI will exploit. Herodotus records the token's characteristic failure: when the sons of a Milesian present the matching tallies to reclaim a deposit, Glaucus of Sparta claims not to remember it, and the oracle punishes the feigned forgetting by extinguishing his line, so that no hearth in Sparta bears his name (VI.86). The surname *Taverner* names the keeper of a house for strangers, which is what Jason of Thessalonica was. It may also recall the Tudor composer John Taverner (c. 1490–1545), whom, according to Foxe, Cardinal Wolsey spared in the Oxford heresy affair of 1528 as being "but a musician," and who later served Thomas Cromwell in the suppression of the friaries at Boston.

"Jason Taverner" thus condenses three figures: the seeker of legitimating tokens, the host of strangers arraigned before the politarchs, and the musician whom authority declines to take seriously. McNulty's database, which finds only a "Jason Tavern," preserves the house and loses the host. The seven-day pass on which Taverner is released is his "security." And the charge laid against his biblical namesake, that his guests have turned the world upside down and proclaimed another king, is the charge the novel's ending will lay against its own world. Dick later summarized what he took to be the hidden story of the book as the return of Christ as king rather than suffering servant, judge rather than victim. The documentary ontology reconstructed in this chapter is the world such a king would turn upside down.

Chapter III

III

Lachrimae Gementes

Groaning tears

KR-3 and the Pharmacology of the Common World



KR-3 is the novel's allegory of totalitarianism: a technology that allows one private world to be administered as the common one, so that a single subject's representation becomes everyone's reality and the one person who remembers otherwise is diagnosed as the dreamer. This chapter reads the drug against the philosophical guarantors of the common world, against the theory of names, against Huxley's mescaline and its fictional successors, and against Arendt's account of totalitarian rule, and concludes that the novel answers its ontological riddle with an ethical one.

3.1 *The Groaning Creation*

Paul writes that the creation "was made subject to vanity, not willingly, but by reason of him who hath subjected the same in hope," that it waits to be delivered "from the bondage of corruption," that "the whole creation groaneth and travaileth in pain together until now," and that the Spirit intercedes "with groanings which cannot be uttered" (Rom. 8:20–26). Dowland's third pavan, *Lachrimae Gementes*, names this register: the tears of a creation subjected, not willingly, to a configuration not its own. No formula describes Taverner's world more exactly. It has been subjected to a will not its own, and it groans. The groan is the voice of the unrecognized before speech: Alcinous hears Odysseus groan before anyone sees his tears (*Od.* VIII.95), and Actaeon groans, and that is his voice (*Met.* III.202).

The premise can be stated briefly. KR-3 is a highly controlled experimental compound, the subject of official trials that the epilogue records as abandoned because the drug proved too destructive. Alys Buckman, a devotee of Taverner's program, takes it. The drug acts not only on her own perception but on the perception of all who exist within her imagined world, and it draws them into that world; Taverner is carried into a world in which he has never existed, and her death, which an autopsy attributes to the drug, returns him to his own. The novel's genesis lay in another drug. Dick told Sandra Meisel in August 1970 that the newly finished draft owed its change of direction to a very large dose of mescaline, whose insights were "all having to do with those whom I loved," and he called the book "the first really new thing" he had written since *Eye in the Sky* (1957). The first French translation was titled *Le Prisme du néant* (1975): the prism of nothingness.

Gerald Jonas, reviewing the novel in 1975, judged its closing rationalization an artistic miscalculation and a major flaw, and much subsequent criticism has agreed. This chapter argues the opposite. The rationalization is the novel's political argument. It does not dispel the nightmare; it identifies its author. Taverner's erasure was the work

neither of a cosmic demiurge nor of a conspiracy, but the side effect of a private appetite with access to the state's pharmacopeia.

3.2 *Kant's Test and the Dreamer of Power*

For Kant, space is nothing but the form of all appearances of outer sense, the subjective condition of sensibility under which alone outer intuition is possible for us (*Kritik der reinen Vernunft*, A26/B42). Its transcendental ideality is compatible with its empirical reality (A28/B44) because the form is the same in every human subject. The commonness of the empirical world rests on the universality of the forms of intuition: no one constructs space otherwise than anyone else. KR-3, which acts on perception itself, privatizes the form, and under Dick's premise the privatized form is contagious.

Fifteen years before the first *Critique*, Kant had formulated the criterion the novel tests. In *Träume eines Geistersehers* (1766) he cites a saying he attributes to "Aristotle," in fact Heraclitus's (B89): awake we share a common world, but dreaming each has his own. Kant proposes to invert it: if different people each have their own world, it is to be presumed that they are dreaming (Part One, ch. 3). He applies the criterion to two classes of dreamers, the dreamers of reason (the metaphysicians) and the dreamers of sense (Swedenborg). Commonness is the mark of waking.

The novel exposes the criterion's weakness. A dream imposed on everyone passes Kant's test, because it is common; only the man who remembers another world fails it, and the criterion diagnoses him as the dreamer. Taverner occupies the position of Kant's spirit-seer, with the difference that his vision is true. To Kant's two dreamers the novel adds a third, the dreamer of power, whose private world is administered as the common one and thereby acquires the outward form of wakefulness. Totalitarianism, in this precise sense, is a dream that passes the test of waking.

3.3 *Leibniz's Palace and the Window in the Monad*

Leibniz's monads have no windows (*Monadologie* §7). Each mirrors the whole universe from its own point of view, as one city appears different from different sides, so that there are as many universes as there are monads, all of them perspectives on one (§§56–57). Their agreement is pre-established by God. The common world is guaranteed by a divine calculation that no monad controls.

The *Théodicée* closes with a myth that reads, after Dick, as an allegory of the archive (§§405–417). Theodorus, dreaming in the temple of Pallas, is led through the Palace of the Fates, whose apartments are possible worlds, each containing a different Sextus. In each apartment lies a great volume holding the history of that world, and a finger

placed on any line makes the scene appear (§414). Leibniz's palace is an archive of worlds, each defined by its book. KR-3 moves Taverner from one apartment into another whose book contains no line about him.

The drug also opens a window in a single monad and lets its perspective overwrite the others: harmony is no longer pre-established but imposed. And it violates the metaphysics of world-bound individuals. Leibniz told Arnauld (1686) that an Adam with different predicates would be another Adam, a "vague Adam"; David Lewis's counterpart theory (1968; *On the Plurality of Worlds*, 1986) holds that individuals are confined to their worlds and that worlds are causally isolated. Dick's premise breaches both doctrines. Taverner is not a counterpart but the same man carried across, a transworld individual whose sameness no one in his new world can verify.

3.4 *Rigid Designators in a Descriptivist State*

In January 1970, the year Dick drafted the novel, Saul Kripke delivered at Princeton the lectures published as *Naming and Necessity* (1972; 1980). Against the descriptivism of Frege and Russell, he argued that proper names are rigid designators: they refer to the same individual in every possible world in which that individual exists, whatever descriptions he satisfies there. KR-3 turns Kripke's thought experiment into narrative. In Alys's world every description of Taverner fails (host of a program watched by thirty million, recording artist, citizen of record), and the name still picks him out.

The documentary state, by contrast, is descriptivist by constitution. It identifies persons by the satisfaction of descriptions held in files. McNulty's "Jason Tavern" is descriptivism's characteristic error: the nearest satisfier of the description, and the wrong man.

Kripke also proposed that a name refers, for a community, by way of a chain of communication reaching back to an initial baptism. In Alys's world no such chain leads to Taverner; he alone holds the baptism. He can refer to himself rigidly, but no one else can refer to him at all. The novel thus separates the metaphysics of reference, which remains intact, from its sociology, which has been severed. Recognition, in Kripkean terms, is the restoration of a chain, and the jukebox of Chapter I is the moment at which the chain is spliced.

Stanisław Lem's *Solaris* (1961) supplies the inverse case. The ocean of Solaris materializes, out of a scientist's memory, the wife whose suicide years earlier he blames on himself. The visitor has no history except his recollection of her, and when she learns what she is, she asks to be annihilated. Lem's Rheya is a chain without a history, a per-

son who exists only in another's memory; Taverner is a history without a chain, a person who exists only in his own.

3.5 *Huxley Inverted*

Aldous Huxley's *The Doors of Perception* (1954) records his mescaline experience of May 1953 and interprets it through C. D. Broad's adaptation of Bergson: the brain is a reducing valve that filters a "Mind at Large" down to what survival requires, and the drug opens the valve. Yet Huxley begins by affirming an irreducible solitude: "The martyrs go hand in hand into the arena; they are crucified alone." Embraced lovers, he adds, try in vain to fuse their insulated ecstasies. Huxley's drug opens the self toward the universal and leaves each self alone.

Dick's own mescaline, by his account, yielded insights into love. In the novel the drug appears once, at the Buckman house: Taverner accepts mescaline from Alys and reacts badly; she leaves to find an antidote; he finds her skeleton. The Huxleyan drug fails because the anti-Huxleyan drug has already succeeded. KR-3 does not open a self to Mind at Large; it enlarges one mind until it encloses others. It abolishes Huxley's solitude not by love but by capture.

KR-3 is the term of a series that runs through Dick's work and beyond it (Table 3). In *Eye in the Sky*, eight people injured in an accident at a particle accelerator fall successively into worlds structured by each one's private beliefs, so that every prejudice becomes, in turn, everyone's cosmos. In *The Three Stigmata of Palmer Eldritch* (1965), the drug Chew-Z draws its users into the universe of a single man who reigns there as god. Ursula K. Le Guin's *The Lathe of Heaven* (1971) hands a man whose dreams retroactively alter reality to a psychiatrist who steers them toward social engineering, and Stanisław Lem's *Kongres futurologiczny* (1971) imagines a government that drapes a ruined world in pharmacological illusion. Calderón's *La vida es sueño* (1635) had already shown a king drugging his son to move him between tower and throne.

Table 3. The pharmacology of worlds

Text	Agent	Whose world becomes common	Who remembers	Political form
Calderón, *La vida es sueño* (1635)	A sleeping draught of opium, poppy, and henbane	The king's staging	Segismundo, uncertainly	Reason of state
Huxley, *Brave New World* (1932)	Soma	The state's consensus	No one	Benevolent totalitarianism

Text	Agent	Whose world becomes common	Who remembers	Political form
Huxley, *The Doors of Perception* (1954)	Mescaline	Mind at Large	The user alone	Mysticism; solitude intact
Dick, *Eye in the Sky* (1957)	A particle-accelerator accident	Each victim's beliefs in turn	All, successively	A rotating tyranny of private worlds
Dick, *The Three Stigmata of Palmer Eldritch* (1965)	Chew-Z	One man's, who reigns there as god	The captured, dimly	Theocracy of a demiurge
Le Guin, *The Lathe of Heaven* (1971)	Effective dreams	The dreamer's, steered by his psychiatrist	The dreamer alone	Technocratic engineering
Lem, *Kongres futurologiczny* (1971)	Psychochemical masking agents	The government's	No one, until the antidote	Rule by pharmacology
Dick, *Flow My Tears* (1974)	KR-3	A devotee's	Taverner alone	The household's dream as the city's world

3.6 *The Idios Kosmos as Totalitarian Allegory*

Hannah Arendt's "Ideology and Terror" (1953), appended to the 1958 edition of *The Origins of Totalitarianism*, argues that ideological thinking emancipates itself from experience, and that the ideal subject of totalitarian rule is not the convinced believer but the person for whom the distinctions between fact and fiction and between true and false no longer exist. Its ground is loneliness, the experience of not belonging to the world at all, and with it the loss of common sense, the sense that fits the other senses into a common world. *The Human Condition* (1958) states the positive principle: the presence of others who see what we see and hear what we hear assures us of the reality of the world and of ourselves. Taverner's predicament is its photographic negative. No one has seen what he saw or heard what he heard.

Orwell gave the doctrine its inquisitor. O'Brien teaches Winston that reality exists only in the mind of the Party, and when Winston protests that this is solipsism, O'Brien answers: "Collective solipsism, if you like." KR-3 is the pharmacology of collective solipsism, one subject's representation administered as everyone's.

Arendt also distinguished the household (*oikos*) from the city (*polis*) and diagnosed modern "society" as a nationwide administration of housekeeping (*The Human Condition*, ch. 2). KR-3 marks the extreme of that colonization. A compound from the state's own pharmacopeia, taken privately in the general's household, rearranges the city's records around one woman's fantasy. The archive is not falsified. It records, with perfect accuracy, a dream.

Why should a devotee's world exclude her idol's fame? The novel invites a reading in terms of possession. The devotee's extreme fantasy is a star who belongs to no audience but hers, and Alys owns his records in a world where no one else has heard them: the collector's dream of the unique copy. Benjamin called ownership the most intimate relationship one can have to objects ("Ich packe meine Bibliothek aus," 1931). KR-3 realizes the collector's dream upon a human being. Ruth Rae will name the error exactly: love is not wanting another person as one wants an object in a shop (Chapter IV).

Le Guin's novel makes the dreamer the victim and the technocrat the tyrant. Dick makes the dreamer a member of the tyrant's household and the victim a man with no dream at all. In a later essay Dick glossed the premise metaphysically: in this novel, he wrote, "the world of one character invades the world in general," revealing that what we call world is Mind, the immanent Mind that dreams our world, as Brahman dreams Maya (*The Shifting Realities of Philip K. Dick*, 1995, 218). The present reading contests the author's gloss. The novel shows not that the world is a Mind's dream, but that a world can be made into someone's dream by whoever has access to the means.

3.7 *Which Dreamed It?*

In the fourth chapter of *Through the Looking-Glass* (1871), Tweedledee shows Alice the sleeping Red King and tells her that he is dreaming about her: "You'd be nowhere. Why, you're only a sort of thing in his dream!" If the King were to wake, Tweedledum adds, "you'd go out—bang!—just like a candle!" Alice weeps, and offers her tears as proof that she is real; Tweedledum dismisses them with contempt (the third epigraph of this dissertation). The book's last chapter asks "Which dreamed it?" and leaves the question open: the King was part of Alice's dream, but she was part of his.

The novel's Alys is an Alice who has become the Red King, and Taverner is the sort of thing in her dream. The inversion is exact. When Carroll's King wakes, Alice goes out like a candle; when Alys dies, Taverner is restored. The tears Alice offers as proof inside the dream are dismissed as unreal; the novel's real tears are shed only after the dream has ended, in the restored common world, by the dreamer's brother.

The question has a long genealogy. Zhuangzi, waking from a dream in which he was a butterfly, could not tell whether he was Zhuang Zhou dreaming he was a butterfly or a butterfly dreaming he was Zhuang Zhou, and concluded only that there must be some distinction: this is called the transformation of things. In Borges's "Las ruinas circulares" (1940), a man who dreams a son into existence discovers, when the fire does not burn him, that he too is dreamt. Calderón's *La vida es sueño* gives the question its political form. King Basilio has his son Segismundo drugged with a draught of opium,

poppy, and henbane, carried from his tower to the throne, drugged again, and returned, and then has him told that the reign was a dream. Segismundo concludes that "toda la vida es sueño, / y los sueños, sueños son" (Act II). In Act III, freed and still uncertain, he resolves that whether it be truth or dream, "obrar bien es lo que importa": to act well is what matters.

Segismundo's resolution is the hinge on which this dissertation turns. When the ontological question cannot be settled, the ethical question remains, and it is answered by a deed. Dick's best-known definition, that reality is that which, when you stop believing in it, doesn't go away (1978), fails the novel's test in both directions: Taverner never stops believing in his reality, and it goes away; the regime never believed in him, and he does not go away. Dick said in 1977 that he had begun the book intending to discover what reality was, and "decided the thing that was really real was love." The novel's criterion is neither persistence nor belief but love, and its corollary, loss: the real is what can be mourned.

3.8 *The Tomb World*

Ludwig Binswanger's existential analysis described a patient's world contracting into a "tomb world" (*Gruftwelt*), in the case history published as "Der Fall Ellen West" (1944–45) and made available to American readers in the anthology *Existence* (1958). Dick took the phrase into *Martian Time-Slip* (1964), where a disturbed child perceives the world's decay into rubble, and the entropic regression of *Ubik* (1969) generalizes it. In Dick's fiction, a private world sealed against the common world decays. Binswanger's case shows what the phrase can conceal. Ellen West, a young woman with a severe eating disorder, took her own life in 1921, and Binswanger read her death as the consummation of her existence, a reading later criticized as the analyst's acquiescence in his patient's death. The novel refuses that reading: the skeleton on the bathroom floor is not the fulfilment of a private world but its indictment.

What Taverner finds on the Buckmans' bathroom floor is not a body but a skeleton. Heraclitus supplies the gloss: death is what we see awake; what we see asleep is sleep (DK 22 B21). Taverner, the one waking man in a dreamer's world, sees death. Holbein's *Ambassadors* (1533) conceals a skull that can be seen only from an oblique angle; Taverner is the oblique angle on Alys's world, and from his position its hostess is already bone. When the dreamer dies, the private world reveals its truth as a tomb.

This is the precise sense in which the chapter's tears are *gementes*. The drugged world groans and ends in a skeleton, and the groan becomes weeping only when the

common world returns. The reality principle arrives as a corpse, and mourning begins where the dream ends. The next chapter follows the novel's lovers up to that threshold.

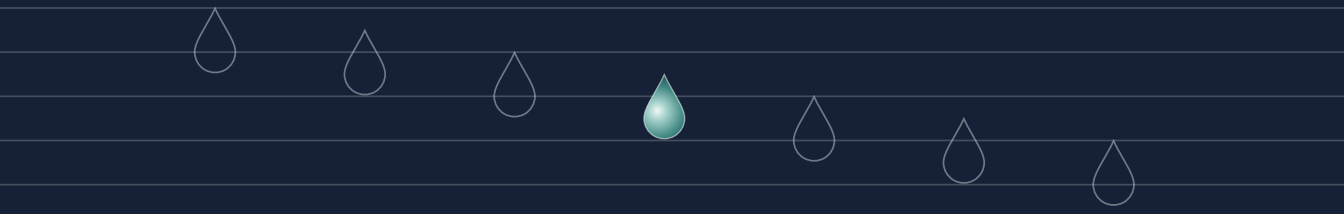
Chapter IV

IV

Lachrimae Tristes

Sad tears

The Ladder of Love



The novel's encounters are not a gallery of types but a ladder. Each instantiates a mode of love; the modes ascend from appetite to gift by decreasing possession and increasing alterity; and each rung is defined by its own relation to tears. Dick said that in writing the book he concluded that what was really real was love. This chapter reconstructs the anatomy through which the novel argues the claim.

4.1 *The Different Stages of Love*

The novel's own archive supports the anatomy (archival notes). An excerpt from an early draft, printed by the Philip K. Dick Society under the title "The Different Stages of Love," shows that the book's working vocabulary was one of stages. When his Doubleday editor, Diane Cleaver, asked in April 1973 that Ruth Rae's long conversation with Taverner be shortened, Dick replied that he regarded it as "the mid-section of the novel," and then tightened it as she asked. An unpublished "Prescript," found with a manuscript of the novel among Dick's papers at California State University, Fullerton, describes the book as beginning with a famous man telling a joke on network television and ending with "an unidentified person loving and cherishing a blue pot." As first conceived, the novel's arc runs from celebrity to the anonymous love of a made thing.

The classical form of such an anatomy is Diotima's ladder (*Symposium* 210a–212a), which ascends from the love of one beautiful body to all beautiful bodies, to beautiful souls, to practices and laws, to knowledge, and at last to the Beautiful itself. Diotima's ladder ascends by abstraction. Dick's ascends by concretion and alterity, from the consumption of another to a gift to a stranger, and its summit is not a form but a man at a gas station. Ruth Rae supplies the novel's own figure for it. When too much of one's heart has gone away, she tells Taverner, one is ready to die, and one climbs the "inclined ladder" while someone else remains behind grieving. Table 4 sets out the seven rungs. Dick himself, describing the draft to a correspondent in October 1970, counted "about ten kinds" of love, ending with one that "has to do with strangers"; the seven rungs here are an interpretive reduction keyed to Dowland's seven pavans.

4.2 *First Rung: The Parasite's Embrace*

The novel opens with a parody of love. A former lover, discarded and resentful, summons Taverner to her apartment and hurls onto his chest a Callisto cuddle sponge, a parasitic organism that roots its feeding tubes in its host; he tears most of it away, but fragments remain inside him. The organism's name is the joke: an embrace that feeds. Michel Serres (*Le Parasite*, 1980) made the parasite the figure of every one-way relation,

the guest who eats at the host's table without returning the gift, exploiting a language in which *hôte* means both host and guest and *parasite* also means static, the noise in a channel. Taverner, whose name designates a host (§2.9), is invaded by a guest, and his catastrophe begins as noise in a broadcast.

The motif returns in mechanical form. The hotel clerk who leads Taverner to the forger fixes a tracking device on him; the police, releasing him after interrogation, attach others; Alys removes them, only to enclose him in her own world. The trackers are the state's cuddle sponges, parasites of information that attach to the body and feed the archive. The novel thus contains three embraces: the parasite's, which draws nourishment from the body; the state's, which registers it (Torpey's *erfassen*, §2.1); and Buckman's at the gas station, which gives. The first two are of one kind. The parasite does not weep, and the first rung is dry.

4.3 *Second Rung: The Narcissism of the Sixes*

The third book of Ovid's *Metamorphoses* contains both Actaeon (III.138–252) and Narcissus (III.339–510), and their cries of self-recognition form a pair. Actaeon's "*Actaeon ego sum*" is never uttered (III.230); Narcissus's "*iste ego sum*," "I am he," is uttered and fatal (III.463). The celebrity is Narcissus and the paperless man is Actaeon, and Taverner passes from the one condition to the other in a single night.

Echo, who can repeat only the last words of others until she wastes away to a voice (III.356–401), is Ovid's figure of an audience. Thirty million viewers return the star's words to him; when they fall silent, he discovers that he had loved an echo. The sixes are engineered for the charm Freud ascribed to narcissism ("Zur Einführung des Narzißmus," 1914), the self-contentment and inaccessibility that fascinate in children, cats, beasts of prey, great criminals, and humorists. Taverner and Heather Hart, both sixes, love one another as mirrors love, and Christopher Lasch's *The Culture of Narcissism* (1979) would soon diagnose the society that worshipped such couples.

Ovid records the one remedy. When Narcissus weeps, his tears fall into the pool, trouble the water, and obscure the image (III.474–476): the tear is the solvent of the mirror. Taverner never sheds that tear, and the novel reserves its tears for others. The epilogue reserves the cure for Heather, who abandons her career for seclusion and so becomes the one character to make the choice of Plato's Odysseus (§1.6).

4.4 *Third Rung: The Devotee's Possession*

Alys's love for Taverner is the devotee's. She owns his records in a world where no one else has heard them, and the coroner names her devotion as the mechanism of his trans-

lation. Chapter III read KR-3 as the collector's dream realized upon a human being; the third rung is the erotic form of that dream. Alys strips the state's trackers from Taverner and takes him home, and the gesture of liberation is the gesture of possession.

Ruth Rae names the error with precision. Love, she tells Taverner, is not wanting another person the way one wants an object seen in a shop; to love is to cease to live for oneself and to live for another. The devotee's love fails both clauses: it wants its object as a possession, and it lives for itself through the object. What is possessed is not mourned. The third rung admits only the tears of an audience for an image, such as the crowds who besieged Rudolph Valentino's funeral in 1926.

4.5 *Fourth Rung: Captive Fidelity*

Kathy Nelson, nineteen, forges documents for the criminal underground and informs on its clients for the police, in the hope that her cooperation will buy the release of her husband, Jack, from a forced-labor camp. Dick later recounted that in December 1970, months after drafting her, he met a nineteen-year-old named Kathy who, it emerged a year later, was informing for a police inspector and whose boyfriend was named Jack; he took the coincidence as his first evidence of what he called the precognitive element in his fiction. Kathy's love is fidelity to an absence, and the apparatus holds it in escrow. Her grief is the leverage by which she is governed. She turns the same leverage on others: when Taverner comes to her for papers, she makes her silence to the police conditional on his spending the night with her. Under surveillance, intimacy is extorted with surveillance's own instrument, the threat of a report, and the informer governs as she is governed.

Her prototype is Penelope, the faithful wife of an absent husband, who weaves and unweaves a shroud to deceive the suitors (*Od.* II.93–110; XIX.137–156) and weeps for Odysseus night after night. Kathy is a Penelope whose loom is a forger's bench and whose suitors are the police. She also recalls Philomela's "voice of the shuttle" (§1.1), the woven document by which a voiceless woman testifies; Kathy's woven documents are testimony bent to the service of the informer. Readers have found her unstable and manipulative. The novel presents her instability as the shape a love takes under surveillance.

4.6 *Fifth Rung: The Twin*

Felix and Alys Buckman are twins and lovers, and they have a son, Barney. Chapter VI treats the incest in full; here it is enough to fix its place on the ladder. Aristophanes's myth in the *Symposium* makes each lover a *symbolon*, the matching half of a severed

whole (191d; §2.9). The twins are the literal case: a love that never leaves the same, for which the beloved is the other half of oneself.

The fifth rung's tear is Buckman's grief for Alys, and Schopenhauer supplies its theory. We weep, he argues, not directly from pain but from its repetition in reflection, when we view our own suffering as though it were another's. Weeping is compassion with oneself, compassion thrown back upon its point of departure, and at the death of a loved one we weep for ourselves and for the lot of humankind (*Die Welt als Wille und Vorstellung* I, §67). A twin's grief is the paradigm of the case, since the lost beloved was, in the most literal sense available, oneself. Dick described the first phase of Buckman's grief as psychotic: a rage that fixes on Taverner and fantasizes his death. What converts it is not argument but a dream, and the dream belongs to Chapter VII.

4.7 *Sixth Rung: Ruth Rae's Doctrine of Grief*

Ruth Rae, many times married, a former lover who no longer knows him, delivers in Las Vegas the speech Dick regarded as the novel's center. Her doctrine has four articles. First, love is distinguished from appetite: it is not the wish to own another but a ceasing to live for oneself. Second, grief causes one to leave oneself, to step outside one's "narrow little pelt"; it reunites one with what one has lost, in a merging in which one splits from oneself and accompanies the departed part of the way on its journey, following as far as one can go. Then grief recedes and one phases back into the world without the beloved, but never wholly returns: a fragment of the heart remains where one went, a cut that never heals. Third, love is a cycle: to love, to lose, to grieve, to leave, and to love again. Fourth, grief is the awareness that one will be alone, since solitude is the final destiny of every living creature, and death is the great loneliness. Her examples include the love of pets, entered into with their short lives foreseen. Taverner's reply is incredulous: "In what fucking way?"

The pelt deserves notice. Actaeon was imprisoned in a stag's hide; the prince of the *Hymn of the Pearl* sheds the soiled garment of Egypt (§1.4). Ruth's grief is the reverse of Actaeon's metamorphosis and the equivalent of the prince's release, the movement by which the self steps out of the hide that encloses it. Her name carries its own genealogy. The Ruth of scripture, widowed, refuses to leave her mother-in-law: whither thou goest, I will go; where thou diest, will I die (Ruth 1:16–17). Grief as accompaniment is the oldest meaning of the name.

Augustine provides the classical counterpoint. At the death of a friend he became a great question to himself, and only weeping was sweet to him (*Confessions* IV.4.9); he had poured out his soul upon sand by loving a mortal as though he would never die

(IV.8.13), and he concluded that creatures should be loved in God (IV.12.18). At his mother's death he held back his tears through the burial, and then let them flow as much as they would, making of them a bed for his heart, and rested in them: *dimisi lacrimas … ut effluerent quantum vellent* (IX.12.33), the Augustinian Latin of "flow, my tears." Ruth Rae refuses Augustine's correction. She loves the mortal as mortal, and her grief needs no transcendence to be sweet.

Freud's "Trauer und Melancholie" (1917) made mourning a labor of detachment, in which reality-testing compels the withdrawal of libido from the lost object, and described melancholia as the state in which the shadow of the object falls upon the ego. Ruth's grief is accompaniment rather than detachment, and her uncured cut anticipates the "continuing bonds" model with which bereavement research later challenged Freud (Klass, Silverman, and Nickman, 1996). It also reverses Huxley (§3.5). For Huxley, solitude is why love fails; for Ruth, solitude is what grief teaches, and the ground on which love is chosen. Derrida, mourning his friends, wrote that each death is the end of the world, not of someone in the world (*Chaque fois unique, la fin du monde*, 2003), and in *Béliers* (2003) he read a line of Celan in which the world is gone and the survivor must carry the other. In Dick's novel the hyperbole is literal: Alys's death ends a world.

The doctrine's address is this chapter's last discovery. Ruth delivers it to the wrong man. Taverner cannot receive it, and Buckman, who never hears it, enacts it: he accompanies his dead sister as far as he can go, returns without part of his heart, and gives what remains to a stranger. The doctrine travels through the book like Poe's purloined letter. Lacan held that a letter always arrives at its destination (seminar on "The Purloined Letter," 1956); Derrida objected that it may not ("Le facteur de la vérité," 1975). The novel takes Lacan's side, but only by way of a detour that neither sender nor addressee foresaw.

4.8 *Interlude: The Potter*

Mary Anne Dominic stands beside the ladder rather than on it. A diffident potter, she helps Taverner escape after Alys's death, and it is in her company that the jukebox restores him (§1.2). The epilogue records that her pottery wins an international prize and grows in value, and that she lives into her eighties; the Prescript imagined the novel ending with an unidentified person loving and cherishing a blue pot.

Diotima taught that those who are pregnant in soul, poets and inventive craftsmen, beget offspring that outlive them, as the poems of Homer and Hesiod outlive their makers (*Symposium* 209a–e). The potter's love issues in a durable thing that is loved without being identified. In a novel obsessed with identification, the last image Dick

first imagined was love without identification. The Coda will develop the potter's vessel as the novel's counter-archive.

4.9 *Seventh Rung: The Gift*

The summit is Buckman's gift to the stranger at the all-night gas station: the love of the most other, whose tear is not shed but given. Chapter VII interprets it. Table 4 records the ladder as a whole. Two axes govern the ascent: possession decreases and alterity increases, from a parasite that feeds on a body to a man who hands a drawing of a pierced heart to someone he has never seen.

The decisive feature of the ladder is the path by which its summit is reached. Buckman's tears begin on the fifth rung, as compassion with himself for the loss of his twin; pass through the sixth, as the enactment of Ruth's unheard doctrine of accompaniment; and arrive at the seventh, as a gift. The man who reaches the top commands the apparatus whose embrace belongs to the bottom rung. That is the scandal of the novel, and the subject of the chapters that follow.

Table 4. The ladder of tears

Rung	Figures	Mode of love	Its tear	Antecedent
1. Parasitism	Marilyn Mason; the cuddle sponge; the state's trackers	Love as feeding: the embrace that consumes	None: the parasite does not weep	Serres, *Le Parasite* (1980)
2. Narcissism	Taverner and Heather Hart	Love of one's image in a mirror-twin	The tear that troubles the pool, unshed	Ovid, *Met.* III.339–510; Freud (1914)
3. Possession	Alys as devotee	Love as ownership of the unique copy	None: what is possessed is not mourned	Benjamin, "Ich packe meine Bibliothek aus" (1931)
4. Captive fidelity	Kathy Nelson and Jack	Fidelity to an absence, held in escrow by the police	Grief as leverage	Penelope's web (*Od.* II, XIX)
5. The twin	Felix and Alys Buckman	Love of the same	Compassion with oneself	Aristophanes (*Symp.* 189c–193d); Schopenhauer, *WWV* I §67
6. Elegy	Ruth Rae	Love that includes its own loss	The tear that accompanies the departed	Ruth 1:16–17; Augustine, *Conf.* IV, IX
7. The gift	Buckman and the stranger	Love of the most other	The tear given away	Acts 8:26–40

Chapter V

V

Lachrimae Coactae

Forced tears

The Police State and the Economy of Forced Tears



The police state of the novel is an economy of affect. It forbids the tears it cannot administer, manufactures the tears it can sell, and extracts the tears it needs, and the title reports the one tear it cannot force. This chapter reconstructs that economy from its classical charter, Plato's city of guardians, through its modern theorists, Schmitt, Dostoevsky's Inquisitor, the Frankfurt critique of the culture industry, and Foucault's biopolitics. It argues that Dick's police state is defined less by what it sees than by what it can make people feel.

5.1 *Sinon's Tears*

Dowland's fifth pavan takes its title from a phrase with a precise classical source. In the second book of the *Aeneid*, Aeneas tells how Troy fell: not to Diomedes or Achilles, not to ten years of war or a thousand ships, but to snares and the perjured art of Sinon, *captique dolis lacrimisque coactis*, "taken by tricks and forced tears" (*Aen.* II.195–198). Sinon, the Greek plant, presents himself as a fugitive from his own army and weeps, and the Trojans, as Aeneas confesses, grant life to his tears and pity him besides (II.145); Priam himself orders his bonds loosed. The Wooden Horse, whose song made Odysseus weep at Phaeacia (§1.2), enters the city on the strength of a forged tear.

Sinon's art belongs first to the author of the stratagem he served: the Horse was Odysseus's ruse (*Od.* VIII.492–495). On Ithaca, listening to Penelope weep for the husband who sits before her in a beggar's disguise, Odysseus pities her in his heart, but his eyes stand as though they were horn or iron, and by guile he hides his tears (XIX.209–212). The poem that taught the West to recognize a hero by his tears also gave it the hero who governs them.

The *Aeneid* thus contains, within two books, both the strongest objection to this dissertation's thesis and its strongest confirmation. At Carthage, before the objection is raised, Aeneas stands before the paintings of the Trojan war in Juno's temple, recognizes himself among the combatants (*se quoque principibus permixtum agnovit Achivis*, I.488), and weeps, feeding his soul on an empty picture, groaning, wetting his face with a broad river of tears: *sunt lacrimae rerum et mentem mortalia tangunt* (I.462–465). That is Aristotle's recognition by memory in its purest form (§1.1), a hero weeping before an image of his own past. Sinon's tears are its counterfeit, and the Trojans who trusted tears were destroyed by them.

Read against Virgil, the documentary regime is not irrational. It is the anti-Sinonian state, a polity that has learned the lesson of Troy and trusts no tear, only the token. But the novel's tokens are no safer than Sinon's tears. Kathy forges them for a living, and the regime's own archive, in Alys's world, records a dream. The novel thus places its

reader in a world in which both regimes of attestation are forgeable, and asks which forgery is worse, and whether any tear escapes forgery. Its answer, developed in Chapter VII, is that one kind does: the tear that seeks nothing.

5.2 *The Philosophical Dog*

Plato's charter for the guardians begins with a dog. The guardian must be like a well-bred hound, gentle to those it knows and fierce to those it does not, even when the stranger has done it no harm; Socrates calls the disposition philosophical, because the dog distinguishes friend from enemy by nothing other than knowing the one and not knowing the other (*Rep.* II 375a–376c). The guardians so formed are then forbidden to lament (III 387d–388e), and the tragic poets, whose pity waters the lamenting part of the soul when it ought to be dried up, are banished (X 605c–606b). Dick's police state is the polity of the philosophical dog. Its hostility is aimed not at the guilty but at the unknown, and the man with no file is the stranger par excellence.

Yevgeny Zamyatin had already drawn the line from Plato's guardians to the secret police. In *We* (written 1920–21), the political police of the One State are the Bureau of Guardians, the citizens live in glass apartments, and sexual intimacy requires a pink ticket, a document licensing an hour behind lowered blinds. Zamyatin's state licenses intimacy by document. Dick's licenses pleasure freely and polices attestation instead, and its informer, as §4.5 shows, extorts intimacy with the threat of a report.

Carl Schmitt gave the dog's criterion its modern form. The specific distinction of the political, he argued, is that between friend and enemy, and the enemy is simply the other, the stranger (*Der Begriff des Politischen*, 1932); sovereign is he who decides on the exception (*Politische Theologie*, 1922). The novel's regime is the exception made permanent: a dictatorship instituted after a Second Civil War, with a Director at its apex and police marshals and generals as its field commanders, in which the National Guard besieges the universities and the forced-labor camp waits at the end of every failed checkpoint. Agamben called the camp the hidden *nomos* of modernity and the exception the paradigm of government (*Homo sacer*, 1995; *Stato di eccezione*, 2003). Dick's 1988 has dropped the pretense of hiding either.

Schmitt also held that the significant concepts of the modern theory of the state are secularized theological concepts. Dick, describing the novel's world in 1977, recalled that in it Richard Nixon is remembered as a heroic leader, even as the "Second Only Begotten Son of God." Kantorowicz traced the medieval king's claim to be an image of Christ (§2.4); the regime has completed the political theology by crowning a messiah of

its own. Against that coronation the novel's ending sets what the Thessalonian mob called "another king" (Acts 17:7; §2.9).

The philosophical dog has two ancestors in this dissertation (§§1.3, 1.6). Argos knows his master through every disguise and dies having seen him; Actaeon's hounds, knowing only the stag, tear their master apart. Plato's guardian belongs to the second kind. It recognizes the familiar and attacks the strange, and so it is helpless before a familiar man made strange. Buckman at the gas station will break the dog's rule at its root, by embracing the man he does not know.

5.3 *The One-Way File*

Taverner formulates the regime's first law himself: once the authorities notice you, they never wholly close the file; anonymity, once lost, cannot be regained, and the only safety lies in never being noticed at all. Dick later quoted the novel's description of a state that "knows more about you than you know about yourself" as his definition of a state that must be overthrown. The file is a one-way door. It opens on notice and never shuts.

Bentham's *Panopticon*, which Foucault read as the diagram of disciplinary power, rests on an asymmetry: the inmate is seen without seeing, the inspector sees without being seen, and the subject learns to watch himself. Taverner is the limit case that exposes the asymmetry's presumption. He alone knows more about himself than the file does, and the regime experiences his self-knowledge as a threat. Buckman reflects that for all his fame and following the celebrity is expendable and the policeman is not; in the police state, the honorific pole of Sekula's archive (§2.1) yields precedence to the repressive.

Dick's own file was violated in the period between the novel's drafting and its revision. In November 1971 his house in San Rafael was burglarized and his fireproof file cabinet blown open; the crime was never solved, and Dick spent years attributing it in turn to the police, to radicals, to intelligence agencies, and to himself. His next novel, *A Scanner Darkly* (1977), carried the logic of the one-way file to its end. An undercover narcotics agent, concealed even from his colleagues by a "scramble suit" that renders his identity unreadable, is assigned to surveil himself and fails to recognize the man he watches. The policeman of *Flow My Tears* weeps; the policeman of *Scanner* cannot recognize his own face.

5.4 *The Inquisitor*

Dostoevsky's Grand Inquisitor (*The Brothers Karamazov*, Book V, ch. 5, 1880) is the most searching portrait of the policeman as lover of mankind. Arresting the returned Christ in sixteenth-century Seville, the nonagenarian cardinal explains that humanity cannot bear freedom, that the Church has relieved it of that burden through miracle, mystery, and authority, and that he loves men more truly than Christ did, by giving them bread and order in place of the terrible gift of conscience. The prisoner answers with no argument. He kisses the old man on his bloodless lips. The Inquisitor shudders, opens the door, and sends him away, forbidding him ever to return; the kiss glows in his heart, but he holds to his idea.

Buckman is a Grand Inquisitor of the late twentieth century: cultivated, a listener to classical music, contemptuous of ordinary police, convinced that his labor preserves a coherent society, and capable of framing an innocent man to protect that society and his own secret. Theodore Sturgeon, commending the novel in 1975, called him "a totally detestable character with whom you must empathize." The novel's ending is Dostoevsky's scene reversed. In Seville the prisoner kisses the inquisitor, who resists the kiss; at the gas station the inquisitor embraces the stranger. And the epilogue records what Dostoevsky's cardinal never did: Buckman retires, writes an exposé of the global police apparatus, and is assassinated.

5.5 *The Forger as Demiurge*

Kathy Nelson's trade is demiurgic. The Gnostic demiurge, Ialdabaoth, fashions a counterfeit world and boasts that he is God and there is no other (*Apocryphon of John*); the craftsman of Plato's *Timaeus* shapes the cosmos after an eternal model. Kathy fashions persons. Her cards are the garments of Egypt in which Taverner passes (§1.4), and for the regime they are as real as any others. In a documentary ontology, a well-made forgery is a creation.

The novel's revision coincided with the most celebrated forgery of identity in postwar America. In 1971 Clifford Irving sold McGraw-Hill a fabricated autobiography of Howard Hughes, the country's most famous recluse, on the wager that Hughes would never emerge to deny it; in January 1972 Hughes did emerge, by telephone, and the hoax collapsed. Orson Welles made the affair, together with the art forger Elmyr de Hory, the subject of *F for Fake* (1973). It is the mirror image of Taverner's case: a forger inscribes the life of a celebrity who has withdrawn from visibility, and only the celebrity's living voice can unmake the document. Taverner's living voice unmakes nothing. Modern fiction's patron of the forger's art is another Felix: Thomas Mann's

confidence man Felix Krull (1954), who forges his father's signature as a schoolboy and later travels the world under a marquis's name and papers.

The regime forges as well. Buckman, interrogating Taverner, poses as a "seven," a rank of engineered superiority that does not exist (§2.3); McNulty's archive misidentifies him as a mechanic named Tavern (§2.1); and in Alys's world the archive as a whole is an authorized forgery, an accurate record of a dream (§3.6). The demiurge's boast is the archive's: there is no person outside the file.

5.6 *The Manufacture of Tears*

The regime's partner in the administration of feeling is the industry Taverner serves. Horkheimer and Adorno (*Dialektik der Aufklärung*, 1944/47) argued that the culture industry endlessly cheats its consumers of what it endlessly promises, that amusement is the prolongation of work, and that its stars embody a pseudo-individuality manufactured to measure. The variety program watched by thirty million is the culture industry's product, and its host, engineered in a laboratory, is the pseudo-individual made literal.

The novel's regime is permissive in appetite and absolute in attestation. Recreational drugs are everywhere and the age of consent has been lowered to twelve; pleasure is licensed while movement and identity are policed. Herbert Marcuse's *One-Dimensional Man* (1964) called this combination repressive desublimation: the release of controlled gratifications that binds individuals more tightly to the order that dispenses them. Huxley's *Brave New World* (1932) had already imagined a state that governs through soma, the feelies, and the maxim that everyone belongs to everyone else. Dick's regime governs by a division of labor: the police administer documents, and the broadcast administers feeling.

The terminus of the economy of forced tears is Orwell's. At the end of *Nineteen Eighty-Four*, after O'Brien has broken him by torture in the Ministry of Love, ending in Room 101, Winston Smith sits in the Chestnut Tree Café, and "two gin-scented tears" run down beside his nose as he discovers that he loves Big Brother. The police state's final product is the extracted tear of love for the state. Dick's ending is its exact antithesis: the policeman weeps, and his tears become love for a stranger whose people the state is extinguishing.

5.7 *Biopower: Sixes and Whooping Cranes*

Foucault described modern power as having replaced the sovereign's right to take life or let live with a power to make live and let die (*La Volonté de savoir*, 1976), and argued

that racism is the mechanism by which such a power introduces into the biological continuum a break between what must live and what must die (lecture of 17 March 1976). The novel's regime operates both edges of the biopolitical blade. At one edge stand the sixes, a population made to live by eugenic design. At the other stand Black Americans, reduced by a law allowing each Black couple a single child to a remnant that is, in Dick's later summary, an "ecological rarity," protected "as are wild whooping cranes." The conservationist idiom is the mask of extermination: the regime administers a people's disappearance as the management of an endangered species. The policy has a legal name. The Genocide Convention of 1948 lists among the acts of genocide "imposing measures intended to prevent births within the group" (Article II(d)), and Dick, describing the novel's world in 1977, called it plainly a "fascist genocide against the blacks" that had begun long before the novel's present. The regime commits genocide by statute.

Agamben's bare life names the condition of those whom the camp receives, and the novel's camps receive the undocumented, the students, and the remnant beyond the color line. The epilogue records the regime's most complete victory: the students abandon resistance and enter the forced-labor camps of their own accord, before the camps, years later, dwindle and close. Discipline is perfected when the subject interns himself.

5.8 *The Command That Cannot Be Obeyed*

Chapter II proposed that "Flow, my tears" is the one performative no policeman can enforce (§2.7). The regime reconstructed in this chapter can command nearly every other utterance. It forges documents, extracts confessions, manufactures sorrow for the evening broadcast, and has reduced the most intimate act of a people, the begetting of children, to an article of law. It cannot command a tear. A tear that obeys is not a tear but Sinon's.

The title's grammar now yields its full sense. The imperative is addressed by the policeman to his own eyes; the speech-tag converts it into an item in a record; and the record reports the one event that no record can produce. Where the regime commands tears, it obtains counterfeits. Where its own general weeps unbidden, it produces the only genuine attestation in the book. Table 5 summarizes the economy.

Table 5. Forced and unforced tears

Kind	Paradigm	Who compels	Function	In the novel
Forbidden	Plato's guardians (*Rep.* III 387d–388e)	The law of the city	Hardness: guardians must not lament	The police ethos Buckman embodies until his last night

Kind	Paradigm	Who compels	Function	In the novel
Forged	Sinon before Priam (*Aen.* II.145, 195–198)	The weeper, by art	Deception: to be believed	Forgery transferred from tears to papers: Kathy's cards
Extracted	Room 101 and Winston's last tears (Orwell, 1949)	The interrogator	Conversion: to love the state	Grief held in escrow: Kathy's hope for Jack
Manufactured	The culture industry (Horkheimer and Adorno, 1944/47)	The broadcast	Reconciliation: sorrow as entertainment	The variety program watched by thirty million
Unforced	"Flow, my tears"	No one	Attestation	Buckman at the all-night gas station

Chapter VI

VI

Lachrimae Amantis

A lover's tears

The Twins and the Rule of the Gift



The incest of Felix and Alys Buckman is the novel's figure for a world that refuses the gift: a love that keeps the same for itself, as the twins' household keeps a son, a drug, and in the end a whole world to itself. This chapter places the twins among the sibling lovers of myth and literature from Isis and Osiris to Nabokov's Van and Ada. It extends the typology of Acts to the reputedly incestuous royal siblings who sat in judgment on Paul, and it reads Buckman as Creon and Antigone in one man. Through Lévi-Strauss and Mauss, it argues that the scene at the gas station is the belated performance of the exogamous gift that the twins' love refused.

6.1 *A Sibling Book of Tears*

Dowland dedicated the *Lachrimae* (1604) to Anne of Denmark, queen of England and sister of Christian IV, the Danish king in whose service Dowland then stood as lutenist. The *Seaven Teares* entered the world under the patronage of a royal sister and brother, and their sixth pavan, *Lachrimae Amantis*, the lover's tears, names the register of this chapter.

The novel states the facts sparingly and without prurience. Felix and Alys Buckman are twins; they are lovers; they have a son, Barney. Alys is erotically omnivorous and chemically adventurous, and after her death the press attributes Taverner's supposed motive to jealousy over her rumored affair with Heather Hart. Buckman frames Taverner for her death in order to keep the incest out of view. Sturgeon, commending the book, remarked that readers would forget Alys about as readily as a tattoo on the back of the hand.

Dowland's third line names the bird of this chapter: "Where night's black bird her sad infamy sings." Commentators gloss the bird as the nightingale, Philomela, whom her sister's husband Tereus raped and then silenced by cutting out her tongue (§1.1). Ovid offers a second candidate. In the *Metamorphoses* a crow tells of Nyctimene, changed into an owl, who, conscious of her guilt, flees the sight of others and the light and hides her shame in darkness (II.589–595). Ovid's crow calls her crime the defiling of her father's bed; Hyginus's handbook names the crime as her father Epopeus's rape of her (*Fabulae* 204). On either reading, night's black bird sings an infamy inflicted by a kinsman and hidden from the light, and Dowland's second stanza states the law of such concealment: "Light doth but shame disclose." The Buckman twins' love is mutual, not inflicted, but it too is hidden from the light, and the brother keeps it hidden by framing an innocent man.

6.2 *The Symbolon Made Flesh*

Aristophanes's speech in the *Symposium* (189c–193d) imagines the first human beings as doubled creatures, male with male, female with female, and male with female, whom Zeus cut in two for their insolence. Each of us is now a *symbolon* of a human being, a matching half, forever seeking the half from which it was cut; when the halves find each other they are struck with love and wish never to be parted. Hephaestus, standing over two such lovers with his tools, offers to weld them into one, so that they may live and die as one, and no lover, Aristophanes says, would refuse (192d–e). Love is the name for the desire and pursuit of the whole (192e–193a).

The twins are the case Aristophanes did not imagine: halves that were never separated. They do not seek the other half; they refuse the cut. Their love is not the pursuit of a lost whole but the defense of an unsplit one, and Alys's death is Zeus's knife falling at last. Wagner staged twin love as anagnorisis. In the first act of *Die Walküre* (first performed 1870), Sieglinde recognizes in the stranger Siegmund the face she once saw as her own reflection in a brook, and recognition becomes desire. The twin is the beloved as mirror (§4.3), which is why the fifth rung of the ladder stands so close to the second.

6.3 *Isis Weeping*

Plutarch's *De Iside et Osiride* (c. 100 CE) records that Isis and Osiris loved each other and consorted in the darkness of their mother's womb before they were born (§12). Their brother Set, whom the Greeks called Typhon, murders Osiris and later tears the body into fourteen pieces and scatters them; Isis searches, weeps, and gathers the fragments (§§13–18). Egyptian liturgy preserved the laments of Isis and her sister Nephthys, songs that summon the dead brother home, and Pausanias heard in Egypt that the Nile begins to rise when Isis mourns Osiris, and that her tears swell the river and water the fields (X.32.18). Restored by his sister's grief, Osiris reigns in the underworld as king and judge of the dead, presiding over the hall in which each heart is weighed.

The myth is the archetype of the Buckman twins, with one inversion and one failure. The inversion: in Egypt the sister weeps for the brother, and in Dick the brother weeps for the sister. The failure: Isis gathers the scattered body and restores it to life and sovereignty, but what Buckman's sister leaves, in Taverner's vision, is a skeleton (§3.8), and no lament reassembles it. The novel keeps the myth's fertility nonetheless. The tears of Isis flood the land; Buckman's tears, as Chapter VII will show, cross the color line and fall upon a man whose people the regime is extinguishing. Dowland's first line acquires a mythic source. *Flow, my tears, fall from your springs*: so the Nile was said to rise with the grief of a sister for her brother.

6.4 *Felix, Drusilla, Agrippa, Bernice*

Dick found Felix in Acts (§0.4). The constellation around the procurator is larger, and it is incestuous. Antonius Felix, procurator of Judaea, was married to Drusilla, daughter of Herod Agrippa I (Acts 24:24; Josephus, *Antiquities* XX.141–144). Her brother, Agrippa II, and her sister Bernice were reputed lovers: Josephus reports the rumor (*Ant.* XX.145), and Juvenal mocks the famous diamond that Agrippa gave his incestuous sister (VI.156–158). When Paul, whom Felix held for two years, is heard again under Felix's successor Festus, it is before Agrippa and Bernice, who enter the place of hearing "with great pomp" (Acts 25:23). The Greek is *meta pollēs phantasias*: with much display, with much *phantasia*.

The typology now reaches the core of the novel's plot. The procurator who holds a prisoner he knows to be guiltless is joined by marriage to the royal siblings whose love the empire whispered about, and those siblings enter the court of judgment wrapped in *phantasia*. Dick's Felix is procurator and incestuous brother at once, and his sister's *phantasia*, under KR-3, becomes the world. Festus, Agrippa, and Bernice agreed that Paul had done nothing worthy of death or of bonds, and sent him to Rome a prisoner nonetheless, because he had appealed to Caesar (26:31–32). Buckman knows Taverner to be innocent and frames him.

6.5 *Creon and Antigone in One Man*

Hegel read Sophocles's *Antigone* as the collision of two laws: the divine law of the family, which commands the burial of the dead brother, and the human law of the city, which forbids it (*Phänomenologie des Geistes*, §§444–476). He made the bond of brother and sister the purest ethical relation, on the ground that, being of one blood, they do not desire each other, and he made the loss of the brother irreplaceable for the sister. Antigone herself argues as much in the much-debated lines in which she says she would not have defied the city for a husband or a child, since another could be had, but that with her parents dead no other brother can ever be born (*Antigone* 905–912).

The Buckman twins refute Hegel's premise, since they desire each other, and they collapse his collision into a single man. Buckman is Creon, the law of the city, which he commands, and Antigone, the mourner of the sibling, which he becomes; and on the night of his sister's death the law he commands is used to bury her secret under an innocent man's guilt. Judith Butler (*Antigone's Claim*, 2000) read Antigone, herself the child of an incestuous marriage, as a figure who unsettles the kinship on which the state depends. Dick's novel places that unsettlement inside the state's own general. The tragedy no longer requires two persons: the state mourns, frames, and weeps.

6.6 *The Rule of the Gift*

Claude Lévi-Strauss (*Les Structures élémentaires de la parenté*, 1949) argued that the incest prohibition stands at the threshold between nature and culture, universal like nature and normative like culture, and that it is less a rule forbidding marriage with mother, sister, or daughter than a rule obliging one to give mother, sister, or daughter to others: the supreme rule of the gift. Marcel Mauss (*Essai sur le don*, 1925) had shown that the gift binds by three obligations, to give, to receive, and to reciprocate, and that a gift carries something of its giver that seeks to return. Lévi-Strauss closed his book by naming the dream that every society forbids: the bliss, eternally denied to social man, of a world in which one might keep to oneself.

The Buckman household is that dream. The twins keep one another; they keep their son out of view; they keep a drug from the state's own trials; and through Alys they keep a man, and then a world, to themselves. KR-3 is the incest prohibition's antithesis made pharmacological, the household's refusal to give extended into a refusal to share a world. Literature had imagined such households before. Cocteau's *Les Enfants terribles* (1929) shuts a brother and sister inside a Room whose Game excludes the world, until the siblings' double suicide makes the Room their tomb. Musil's Ulrich and Agathe, who call themselves Siamese twins, falsify their dead father's will and withdraw toward a mystical "other condition" in the unfinished third part of *Der Mann ohne Eigenschaften* (1930–43), "Into the Millennium (The Criminals)." Nabokov's *Ada or Ardor* (1969), published a year before Dick drafted his novel, sets a lifelong love between brother and sister on Antiterra, a world twinned with an Earth that its inhabitants regard as a madman's fantasy. The excluded third pays for the pair: Lucette, the lovers' half-sister, in love with Van and turned away by him, takes her own life. The couple that keeps to itself destroys the one it refuses to admit, as the Buckman twins keep their secret at the cost of an innocent man.

Read through Lévi-Strauss, the gas station acquires a structural meaning that no other reading supplies. On the night of his sister's death, Buckman performs the exogamous gift that the twins' love refused. He gives to the most other person available to him, a stranger outside his family, his class, his office, and his race, and what he gives is the only form his sister still has: his grief for her, drawn as a pierced heart. The incest prohibition obliges one to give the sister away. Buckman gives her away at last, as tears. Mauss's third obligation is fulfilled as well, for Chapter VII will show that the stranger answers with a counter-gift.

Table 6. Sibling love and its laws

Text	Siblings	The bond	The law it meets	The fate of the grief
Sophocles, *Antigone* (c. 441 BCE)	Antigone and Polynices	Duty to an unburied brother	Creon's edict	Walled up alive by Creon's order; she takes her own life in the tomb
Plutarch, *De Iside et Osiride* (c. 100 CE)	Isis and Osiris	Lovers from the womb	Murder and dismemberment by their brother	Tears that raise the Nile and restore the god as judge of the dead
Acts 25–26; Josephus; Juvenal	Agrippa II and Bernice	Reputed lovers	Roman scandal	None recorded; they enter the court "with great pomp"
Wagner, *Die Walküre* (1870)	Siegmund and Sieglinde	Twins who recognize and love each other	The law of marriage and the god's spear	Despair turned toward the child she carries
Cocteau, *Les Enfants terribles* (1929)	Paul and Elisabeth	A sealed Room and its Game	The world outside the Room	The siblings' double suicide in the Room
Musil, *Der Mann ohne Eigenschaften* (1930–43)	Ulrich and Agathe	"Siamese twins" seeking the other condition	The father's will, which they falsify	Suspended in an unfinished book
Nabokov, *Ada or Ardor* (1969)	Van and Ada Veen	Lifelong ardor on a twin world	Family and society on Antiterra	A memoir the lovers write together in old age, after the suicide of the half-sister they excluded
Dick, *Flow My Tears* (1974)	Felix and Alys Buckman	Twins, lovers, parents	The documentary state, which the brother commands	A gift to a stranger

6.7 *Petrine Tears*

The gospels set the most famous tears of the New Testament in a courtyard of the authorities. In the house of the high priest, challenged three times by servants, Peter denies that he knows Jesus: "I know not the man" (Matt. 26:72, 74). The cock crows; Luke adds that the Lord turned and looked upon Peter; and Peter went out and wept bitterly (Luke 22:61–62). Peter's tears are those of a man who has refused recognition under interrogation and has then been recognized by the one he denied.

Buckman's betrayal is Petrine in structure. He knows Taverner to be innocent and declares the contrary; his denial is a refusal of recognition, made inside the apparatus, to save himself; and his tears follow the denial as Peter's do. The Petrine tear became the emblem of a European culture of tears in Dowland's generation: Orlando di Lasso's *Lagrime di San Pietro* (1594), his last work; Robert Southwell's *Marie Magdalens Funeral Teares* (1591) and *Saint Peters Complaint* (1595); the many weeping Peters of El Greco. Dowland, a convert to Catholicism who told Sir Robert Cecil in 1595 that his religion had cost him a place at Elizabeth's court, composed the *Lachrimae* in the shadow of that culture.

The gospels' lover's tears belong to Mary Magdalene, in the tradition that from Gregory the Great onward identified her with the sinner who washed Christ's feet with her tears and of whom it was said that her many sins were forgiven, for she loved much (Luke 7:47). At the empty tomb she weeps and does not recognize the risen Christ, whom she takes for the gardener, until he speaks her name; she turns and answers, "Rabboni" (John 20:11–16). The lover's tear is answered by a name, and the name effects the recognition. Taverner's condition is the negative of the garden: he speaks his own name, and nothing answers. Chapter VII turns to the night on which an answer comes, not as a name but as an embrace.

Chapter VII

VII

Lachrimae Verae

True tears

The Embrace at the All-Night Station



The climax of *Flow My Tears* is a scene of lacrimal anagnorisis that inverts Phaeacia: the sovereign weeps, and the stranger receives. This chapter reconstructs the scene from the novel and from Dick's later accounts of it, reads it through Acts, the Apocalypse, the iconography of the pierced heart, and the *Iliad*'s supreme scene of shared grief, and tests it against the strongest objections to an ethics of tears. It then formulates the dissertation's thesis, *fleo, ergo es*, which survives the test only in qualified form: the tear is a threshold of justice, never its substitute.

7.1 *The Night Flight*

The scene closes the novel's twenty-seventh chapter, and Dick called it the part he had rewritten most carefully. After Alys's death, having resolved to implicate Taverner in it, Buckman flies home through the night. By Dick's account his grief first takes the form of rage: a fixation on Taverner and a fantasy of killing him, a grief so disordered that he forgets he is framing an innocent man. In flight he sleeps and dreams. He is in the countryside of his childhood. A posse of horsemen in helmets and many-colored robes approaches, led by a figure like a wise old king with a beard white as wool; in a building nearby a man is hidden whom the posse means to kill, and the man, hearing them come, cries out in terror. Buckman's rage is transmuted into grief for the hidden man.

He wakes and lands at an all-night gas station, where a Black man is waiting while his car is serviced. Buckman draws a heart pierced by an arrow on a scrap of paper and gives it to him. He takes off, turns back, lands again, and embraces the stranger, and the two men talk. In a speech of 1977 Dick recalled a further detail: the stranger proudly takes out his wallet and shows the general photographs of his three children, although the novel had stipulated that a Black couple may lawfully bear only one. Dick had dreamed Buckman's dream himself while writing the book, and he had been told that the John W. Campbell Memorial Award was given chiefly for this episode. Eight years after drafting it, he recalled, he found himself helping a Black motorist who had run out of gas: he gave the man money, drove away, and then turned back to take him to a station.

Dick also recounted that when he described the scene to an Episcopalian priest, the priest pointed out its resemblance to the eighth chapter of Acts. The resemblance is closer than either man remarked, because that chapter is framed by the career of a policeman. Saul, "breathing out threatenings and slaughter," asks the high priest for letters to the synagogues of Damascus, so that he may bring bound to Jerusalem any he finds of the Way (Acts 9:1–2). He is an officer with warrants. On the road a light from heaven strikes him down and a voice asks why he persecutes; blinded, he is led into the

city, and when Ananias lays hands on him there fall from his eyes as it had been scales (9:18). Philip's meeting with the Ethiopian (8:26–40) lies between Saul's persecution (8:1–3) and Saul's conversion (9:1–19). Buckman condenses the frame and the picture. He is Saul struck down on the way, and Philip sent to the stranger's chariot.

7.2 *The Desert Road*

An angel sends Philip to the desert road from Jerusalem to Gaza. There an Ethiopian eunuch, treasurer to Candace, queen of the Ethiopians, sits in his chariot reading Isaiah on his way home from worship, and the Spirit tells Philip: "Go near, and join thyself to this chariot" (8:29). The Greek verb, *kollēthēti*, means to cleave or to be joined, the verb the Gospels use of a man cleaving to his wife (Matt. 19:5). The eunuch is reading the song of the servant: "He was led as a sheep to the slaughter … In his humiliation his judgment was taken away: and who shall declare his generation? for his life is taken from the earth" (Acts 8:32–33; Isa. 53:7–8). He asks Philip, "of whom speaketh the prophet this? of himself, or of some other man?" (8:34). After the baptism the Spirit catches Philip away, and the eunuch, seeing him no more, goes on his way rejoicing (8:39).

Three features of the episode bear on the novel. The first is the question of generation. A man who by his condition can have no descendants reads of a servant whose generation no one shall declare. Deuteronomy excludes the eunuch from the assembly (23:1), and Isaiah reverses the exclusion: to eunuchs who hold fast the covenant, God will give within his house and walls "a place and a name better than of sons and of daughters … an everlasting name, that shall not be cut off" (Isa. 56:4–5). The Hebrew for "a place and a name" is *yad vashem*, which in 1953 became the name of Israel's memorial to the six million Jews murdered by the Nazis and their collaborators. It is the archetypal counter-archive. Since the 1950s it has gathered the victims' names on handwritten Pages of Testimony, submitted by those who remember them and kept in its Hall of Names, against a regime that sought to erase the names together with the people; its own account of the project opens with the last letter of David Berger, written in Vilna in 1941, asking that someone remember "that there once lived a person named David Berger." Dick's stranger belongs to a people whose generation the regime has cut off by statute, and he answers the eunuch's question with his wallet. He declares his generation. The photographs of three children are a counter-archive in miniature, the honorific pole of Sekula's archive (§2.1) carried next to the heart and shown to a policeman.

The second feature is the eunuch's other question: of whom does the prophet speak, of himself or of some other man? It is the question the novel's title poses of its tears. Buckman's tears are for himself, in Schopenhauer's sense, and for his twin, the other half of himself (§4.6); the gift at the gas station gives them another referent. The third feature is the ending. Philip is caught away and seen no more. Buckman departs and comes back. The return is the novel's addition to its source and its ethical signature, and Dick, by his own account, repeated it eight years later without having planned to.

7.3 *The Judge with Hair like Wool*

The dream's king has a scriptural pedigree as exact as the gas station's. Daniel sees the Ancient of Days enthroned, his garment white as snow and the hair of his head like the pure wool; the judgment is set, and the books are opened (Dan. 7:9–10). The Apocalypse transfers the figure to the Son of Man, whose head and hairs are "white like wool, as white as snow" (Rev. 1:14), and later shows a rider called Faithful and True, who in righteousness judges and makes war, followed by the armies of heaven on horseback (19:11–14). Buckman's dream assembles these elements: a white-bearded king, a mounted posse, a judgment about to fall. The books opened before the Ancient of Days are the archive of the Last Judgment, the archetype of the documentary ontology (§2.5).

Dick drew the conclusion himself. Deciphered, he wrote in 1978, the novel tells of the return of Christ as king rather than suffering servant, as judge rather than victim of unjust judgment, and it carries a warning to the powerful that they will shortly be judged. He came to believe that the book had transmitted a two-word cipher, KING FELIX, and Tim Powers recalled him pointing out that on page 218 of the first edition a paragraph break sets the word "king" directly above the name "Felix." The procurator of Acts also trembled before judgment. When Paul reasoned before Felix and Drusilla "of righteousness, temperance, and judgment to come, Felix trembled," and sent him away until a more convenient season (Acts 24:25). Buckman's dream is Felix's tremor, with the season no longer deferred.

The dream's most important figure, however, is not the king but the hidden man, whom the posse will kill and toward whom Buckman's grief turns. Who is he? He is Taverner, the man Buckman has resolved to destroy; but under the sign of judgment he is also Buckman himself, the powerful man about to be judged. The dream fuses the persecuted and the guilty in a single cry, and Buckman's grief for the hidden man is at once compassion for his victim and fear for himself. Simone Weil located the sacred in a

human being in exactly such a cry, the impersonal protest "Why am I being hurt?", and argued that what is sacred in us is not the person but the impersonal ("La Personne et le sacré," 1943). The documentary regime knows an impersonal of another kind, Agamben's identity without the person (§2.3): data detached from any recognition. The novel sets the two impersonals against each other. The file is the impersonal of the archive, and the cry is the impersonal of the sacred. Buckman, master of the first, hears the second.

7.4 *The Pierced Heart*

Buckman's drawing belongs to the oldest vocabulary of European love. Ovid's Cupid wounds Apollo with a golden arrow (*Met.* I.452–476). Augustine wrote that God had pierced our heart with charity, *sagittaveras tu cor nostrum caritate tua* (*Confessions* IX.2.3), and the arrow-pierced heart became his emblem. Teresa of Ávila describes an angel driving a fiery dart into her heart (*Libro de la vida*, ch. 29), the scene Bernini carved for the Cornaro Chapel (1647–52). The pierced heart is also the oldest graffito of lovers. A police general who draws it on a scrap of paper speaks the vernacular of love with the full weight of its tradition behind him.

The tradition carries a second image that bears directly on the giver. At the crucifixion a soldier pierces Christ's side with a spear (John 19:34), and the evangelist cites Zechariah: "They shall look on him whom they pierced" (19:37). Zechariah's prophecy continues, "and they shall mourn for him, as one mourneth for his only son" (Zech. 12:10), and the Apocalypse joins it to the coming of the judge, whom every eye shall see, "and they also which pierced him" (Rev. 1:7). Medieval legend named the soldier Longinus and told that blood ran down the spear onto his failing eyes and healed them, and that he believed (*Legenda aurea*). The piercer who mourns the pierced, the soldier whose sight is restored by the wound he made: that is Buckman's figure exactly, and his drawing is the confession of an officer of the lance.

The Elizabethan pun on *hart* and *heart* supplies a third sense. Jaques watches a wounded stag weep beside a brook, "the big round tears / Coursed one another down his innocent nose / In piteous chase" (*As You Like It* II.i). The Psalmist's hart pants after the water brooks, and his tears have been his meat day and night (Ps. 42:1, 3). Cowper's "stricken deer," with many an arrow in his side, is found "by one who had himself / Been hurt by th' archers," who draws out the darts and bids him live (*The Task*, 1785, III.108–116). Buckman's name contains the buck; his drawing is a hart pierced by an arrow; and the man who receives it belongs to a people the archers have hurt. The hunter of Chapter I returns here transfigured. Actaeon, master of hounds,

becomes the stricken deer, and finds, in the person his apparatus has wounded, the one who lets him live.

An Egyptian sense completes the emblem. In the judgment over which Osiris presides (§6.3), the heart of the dead is weighed, and a spell entreats the heart not to rise as a witness against its owner (Book of the Dead, spell 30B). Buckman draws his heart and hands it to a stranger. He gives away the witness that would condemn him.

7.5 *Priam and Achilles*

The ancient scene closest to the gas station is the last book of the *Iliad*. Guided at night by Hermes, who puts the Achaean sentries to sleep (XXIV.443–447), Priam crosses into the enemy camp to ransom his son's body. He kisses the hands of Achilles, the terrible man-slaying hands that had killed many of his sons (477–479), and asks Achilles to remember his own father (486–506). The two men weep together, Priam for Hector, Achilles for his father and then for Patroclus, and the sound of their mourning fills the hut (507–512). Afterward they eat, and each looks at the other in wonder, Priam at Achilles's stature and beauty, Achilles at Priam's noble face and speech (628–633). Achilles returns the body and grants a truce for the burial.

The correspondences are structural. There is a night journey across the line of enmity, and a guide who is called, throughout the book, Argeiphontes, the slayer of Argus: the god who disarmed the hundred-eyed watchman with the story of a lament (§1.3). There is grief shared across the line for different dead, a gift, and a mutual wonder in which each man sees the other as a person. Simone Weil read the *Iliad* as the poem of force, which turns whoever is subjected to it into a thing, and found in such moments the rare intervals in which force is suspended and enemies see one another ("L'Iliade ou le poème de la force," 1940–41). *Flow My Tears* is a novel of force with one such interval. The difference is instructive: in the *Iliad* both men weep, but at the gas station only the policeman's tears are recorded.

7.6 *The Objections*

Chapter V raised the first objection: tears can be forged, as Sinon's were (§5.1). An ethics of tears must survive at least four more, and the novel survives them only in part.

Milan Kundera (*The Unbearable Lightness of Being*, 1984) distinguished two tears. The first says how nice to see children running on the grass; the second says how nice to be moved, together with all mankind, by children running on the grass. "It is the second tear that makes kitsch kitsch." Kundera tied kitsch to totalitarianism, whose parades stage the brotherhood of man as an aesthetic ideal. The gas-station scene invites

the second tear twice: Buckman may be moved by his own being moved, and the reader by the spectacle of a policeman embracing a stranger. The novel's partial answer is structural. Buckman's tears begin as the second kind, compassion with himself (§4.6), and the gift turns them outward toward someone who is not the weeper. The book guards the turn with flatness: the epilogue's actuarial register, the refusal to narrate the stranger's feelings, Buckman's undiminished complicity. Dick himself, rereading the draft early in 1973, judged it "sentimental" and rewrote it for "grit" (letter to Goran Bengston, 4 May 1973). The scene's restraint is the product of an anti-sentimental revision.

James Baldwin ("Everybody's Protest Novel," 1949) called sentimentality the ostentatious parading of excessive and spurious emotion, the mark of dishonesty and of the inability to feel: "the wet eyes of the sentimentalist betray his aversion to experience," and they signal a secret inhumanity, a mask of cruelty. The objection strikes the novel at its center. The policeman who weeps over a stranger has just framed an innocent man, and his tears do not undo the frame. Baldwin is right about the tears taken alone. What the novel adds is their sequel. According to the epilogue, Buckman retires, writes an exposé of the global police apparatus, and is assassinated. Whatever its motives, the exposé is the tear converted into testimony at cost. The novel validates the tear not by its sincerity, which no one can verify, but by what it costs the weeper afterward.

A theological form of Baldwin's objection is hidden in the general's name. The Easter *Exsultet* sings *O felix culpa*, O happy fault, of the sin that merited so great a Redeemer, and any reading of the novel as Buckman's redemption risks making his crime the happy occasion of his grace. The fault is happy for no one but the redeemed. It is not happy for Taverner, charged with a death he did not cause, nor for the stranger's people, whose disappearance the regime administers by law. A political form of the danger appeared early. In a 1977 interview Dick recalled that a French editor had read the novel as a defense of a law-and-order state, because the police general is treated sympathetically; he answered that Buckman earns sympathy only through his conversion to love for the very kind of person he had persecuted, the stranger, since the essence of police persecution is that every citizen is a stranger suspected of evil intent. The novel resists both consolations by refusing to let the tear undo anything: the charge against Taverner stands until the epilogue clears him, and no law is repealed in the text.

Toni Morrison (*Playing in the Dark*, 1992) showed how American literature has used an "Africanist presence" as a surrogate through which white writers meditate on their own freedom, guilt, and grace. The stranger is unnamed, scarcely described, and present chiefly to receive Buckman's grief; Dick himself, recounting the scene, called him "some black guy." Spike Lee, in 2001, gave the figure its derisive name in criticism

of American film, the "magical Negro": a Black character who exists to rescue or redeem a white protagonist. The regime's near-extermination of Black Americans is a premise the novel states and does not explore. This objection the novel does not survive intact. Two things qualify the verdict. The stranger is not merely passive. In Dick's own account of the ending, written in October 1970, the man is at first puzzled and displeased at being embraced by a stranger, a response that registers the distance between a police general and a member of a persecuted people; only then does he answer with understanding and invite Buckman to his home to meet his wife and children. The persecuted man becomes the host, and the policeman his guest. In the published scene he answers with his photographs, a counter-gift that declares his generation against the law (§7.2). And Dick's later reading, that at the gas station Buckman has slipped into a world in which Black families are no longer restricted, may be taken as the novel's own intuition that grace requires a changed world and not only a changed heart. The lacrimal regime remains incomplete as long as the stranger's tears, if he sheds any, go unrecorded.

Hannah Arendt (*On Revolution*, 1963) argued that compassion is mute, speaking in gestures rather than arguments (her example is the Christ of Dostoevsky's legend, who answers the Inquisitor with a kiss), and that it abolishes the worldly space between persons in which politics takes place; pity, its generalized form, has proved capable of greater cruelty than cruelty itself. Arendt's analysis fits the scene precisely and marks its limit. Buckman's gesture is compassion in her sense: particular and mute, a drawing and an embrace. It answers one man and no regime. The exposé, by contrast, enters the common world as speech. The novel's ethics requires both.

Dick had staged the problem of verifying a tear in his own earlier work. In *Do Androids Dream of Electric Sheep?* (1968) the police certify humanity with the Voigt-Kampff test, which measures involuntary signs of empathy such as the blush and the tension of the eye muscles: the documentary regime's attempt to verify a tear. The test fails at its margins, and the novel's empathic religion, Mercerism, is exposed as a staged fake that nonetheless continues to grant grace. *VALIS* (1981) would later parody *Flow My Tears* under the title *The Android Cried Me a River*. Dick's own work thus reminds its reader that a tear may be produced by a machine and that no instrument can certify one. A tear can only be acknowledged.

7.7 *Fleo, ergo es*

Descartes founded modern philosophy on a first-person certainty: I think, therefore I am (*Discours de la méthode*, 1637); I am, I exist, as often as I conceive it (*Meditationes*

II, 1641). Augustine had anticipated him: if I am deceived, I am (*De civitate Dei* XI.26). Taverner possesses this certainty intact, together with Ricoeur's attestation (§2.8), and the novel shows it to be socially worthless. A man can be certain that he exists and exist for no one. What the novel discovers is that existence in the common world is conferred in the second person.

The discovery has several modern formulations. Martin Buber wrote that in the beginning is the relation, that a human being becomes an I through the Thou, and that all real living is meeting (*Ich und Du*, 1923). For Emmanuel Levinas the face of the other speaks before I do and forbids me to kill (*Totalité et infini*, 1961). John Mbiti rendered an African communal ontology in the formula "I am, because we are; and since we are, therefore I am" (*African Religions and Philosophy*, 1969), the sense of the southern African maxim *umuntu ngumuntu ngabantu*, a person is a person through other persons. Cavell held that the other's suffering is to be acknowledged rather than known (§2.8), and Ricoeur, in his last book, found in agape and the ceremonial gift the "states of peace" in which the struggle for recognition is suspended (*Parcours de la reconnaissance*, 2004).

The novel adds the medium. Its second-person ontology is lacrimal, and the formula this dissertation proposes is *fleo, ergo es*: I weep, therefore you are. The formula states an acknowledgment, not an inference, for tears prove nothing, as Sinon taught. In weeping for or toward another, I let that other appear in the common world as one whose loss would be a loss. Lear knows it. Mad in the fields near Dover, he recognizes the blinded Gloucester by the tears Gloucester would shed for him, "If thou wilt weep my fortunes, take my eyes; / I know thee well enough; thy name is Gloucester," and reminds him that "we came crying hither," that the first sign a human being gives of being in the world is a cry (IV.vi). Waking in Cordelia's care, he tests her tears: "Be your tears wet?" (IV.vii). Thomas touched wounds (§1.4); Lear touches tears. They are wet, and recognition follows. He thinks this lady to be his child Cordelia, and she answers, "And so I am, I am."

The formula has an eschatological horizon in the chapter on love that Dick invoked when he explained this novel (1 Cor. 13), and from which he took the title of the next: "For now we see through a glass, darkly; but then face to face: now I know in part; but then shall I know even as also I am known" (13:12). The final recognition is mutual and second-personal: to know as one is known. Before that face to face, the tear is its provisional form.

The formula must also be completed. Buckman's tear acknowledges one man; it does not repeal a law. The epilogue supplies the completion: the tear becomes testimony, the testimony enters the common world as an exposé, and its author pays for it

with his life. The Greek for witness is *martys*. The full formula is therefore triadic, *fleo, ergo es; ideo testor*: I weep, therefore you are; therefore I bear witness. The tear opens what testimony must carry into the world, and what justice must finally secure.

History supplies the measure of that completion. In *Eichmann in Jerusalem* (1963) Hannah Arendt dwelt on testimony given at the trial about Anton Schmid, a Viennese radio-shop owner serving as a sergeant in the German army in occupied Vilna. When the German authorities there issued three thousand work permits in October 1941, each protecting its holder and three relatives, the Jews without permits were to be killed. Schmid saw that his Jewish workers received as many permits as possible, provided papers to others, got prisoners released, hid Jews in his apartment and office, and carried members of the Jewish underground in army trucks to other cities. In January 1942 he was arrested; a German military court convicted him of high treason, and he was executed in April. From his cell he wrote to his wife that he had only acted as a human being (Yad Vashem). Arendt drew two lessons: that the holes of oblivion terror digs do not exist, because there are too many people in the world for forgetting to be complete, and that under terror most people will comply but some will not. Discussing Buckman in a 1977 interview, Dick gave the second lesson its fictional form: within such an apparatus, he said, there are individuals capable of mitigating the tyranny for which they speak. Buckman is no Schmid. Schmid turned the papers of a documentary regime into instruments of rescue before his arrest; Buckman weeps after his crime and testifies only in retirement. But the epilogue sets him on Schmid's road, from inside the apparatus to testimony against it, and charges him the same price. In 1964 Yad Vashem recognized Schmid as Righteous Among the Nations.

7.8 *Lachrimae Verae*

Dowland's seventh pavan names true tears. The chapters of this dissertation yield five criteria by which a tear may be called true, each excluding a counterfeit (Table 7). None can be verified by an instrument; each can be acknowledged.

Measured against them, Buckman's tear is unbidden, since it follows a dream he did not choose; turned outward, since it becomes a gift; costly, since it is followed by testimony and death; answered, though only in part, by the stranger's counter-gift; and it asks nothing in return. Derrida argued that a pure gift must not even appear as a gift, lest the recognition it earns repay it (*Donner le temps*, 1991), and the drawing at the gas station comes as near that condition as a drawn heart can. The tear thus meets four of the criteria fully and one, reciprocity, only in part. That partiality is the novel's honesty.

The thesis can now be stated in its final form. *Flow My Tears* opposes two regimes of attestation, the documentary and the lacrimal, and places the second inside the first: the law weeps. The tear does not replace the file. It precedes the file, as acknowledgment precedes justice, and it judges the file, as the cry of the hidden man judges the posse. The tear is a threshold of justice, never its substitute.

Table 7. Five criteria of a true tear

Criterion	Counterfeit excluded	Source of the objection	At the gas station
Unbidden	The forged tear	Virgil, *Aen.* II (Sinon)	It follows a dream Buckman did not choose
Turned outward	The second tear; compassion with oneself	Kundera (1984); Schopenhauer, *WWV* I §67	Grief for a twin becomes a gift to a stranger
Costly	The sentimentalist's wet eyes	Baldwin (1949)	The exposé and the assassination recorded in the epilogue
Answered	The instrumental presence	Morrison (1992)	Partly met: the stranger answers with photographs of his children and, in Dick's account, an invitation to his home
Seeking nothing	The extracted and the manufactured tear	Orwell (1949); Horkheimer and Adorno (1944/47); Derrida (1991)	A drawing that asks nothing back

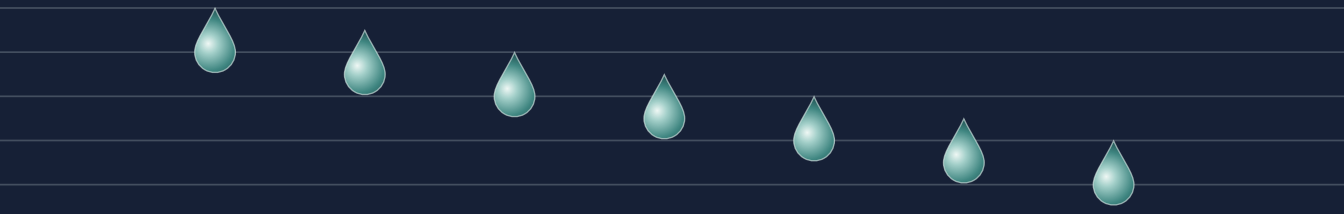
Coda

Galliard

Hark! you shadows that in darkness dwell

The ayre's last stanza

Toward a Dacryology of the Documentary Age



The argument of this dissertation extends beyond its novel: every regime of identification is also a regime of feeling, and a documentary age needs a discipline that studies tears as a mode of attestation. This coda sketches that discipline, which it calls dacryology, and states its theses.

In Dowland's *Lachrimae* the seven pavans are followed by livelier dances, galliards and almands, among them "The King of Denmarks Galiard," for the king Dowland served, and a pavan whose title is also Dowland's motto: *Semper Dowland semper dolens*. A galliard answers the gravity of the pavan by quickening it, and this coda proceeds in the same manner.

An Etymology

A dacryology of the documentary age may begin from an etymology. *Record* derives, through Old French, from the Latin *recordari*, to call to mind, formed on *cor, cordis*, the heart: to record is, literally, to call back to the heart. The novel's records are double. There are the phonograph records that Alys owns and that the jukebox plays, which restore Taverner to the common world (§1.2), and there are the records the police keep, which erase him. The documentary state has severed the record from its root. Buckman's drawing restores it. A heart on a scrap of paper is the novel's first entry in a counter-archive.

The Bottle and the Book

The Psalmist supplies the counter-archive's charter: "Thou tellest my wanderings: put thou my tears into thy bottle: are they not in thy book?" (Ps. 56:8). The Hebrew turns on a pun between *nodi*, my wandering, and *nodekha*, thy skin flask, and its verbs are verbs of counting and recording. The superscription assigns the psalm to David "when the Philistines took him in Gath," the episode in which David, recognized at a foreign court, escapes by feigning madness (1 Sam. 21:10–15). He is a fugitive whose true identity endangers him and whose escape lies in seeming mad, which is Taverner's condition reversed. The book in this psalm is not the book of life, which records names (§2.5). It is a book of tears, kept in order to mourn rather than to govern. That is the counter-archive.

The nineteenth century, misreading the small glass flasks found in Roman tombs, called them lachrymatories and imagined mourners collecting their tears in them; archaeology has since shown that they held perfumes and unguents. The error is instructive. A culture of documents wanted an archive of tears so badly that it invented one.

The Novel's Counter-Archives

Flow My Tears keeps four such archives. The stranger's wallet holds photographs of three children, a family archive that declares a generation against the law (§7.2). Mary Anne Dominic's pottery, which the epilogue says won an international prize, and the blue pot that Dick's Prescript imagined loved and cherished by an unidentified person, preserve love without identification (§4.8). Buckman's exposé of the police apparatus is testimony at cost (§7.7). And the novel itself keeps the record of a man the archive forgot and of a tear the regime could not command.

The Documentary Age

Since 1974 much of what Dick imagined has become ordinary in mild and lawful forms: identification by fingerprint and face at borders, records that follow persons across institutions, the conversion of daily life into data. The characteristic catastrophe of such an order is Taverner's: the person who exists and cannot prove it. In 2018 it emerged that long-settled Commonwealth-born residents of Britain, many of whom had arrived when no papers were required of them, had lost jobs or homes, and in some cases faced deportation, under rules introduced from 2012 that obliged employers, landlords, and health services to demand proof of immigration status. The Home Office confirmed that registration slips recording arrival dates had been destroyed in 2010, a decision the Prime Minister said had been taken in 2009, while maintaining that the slips would not have proved residence (CNN, 18 April 2018). The Prime Minister's answer to Parliament was an acknowledgment rather than a document: "These people are British."

Philosophy registered the same unease early. In January 2004 Giorgio Agamben cancelled a course he was to teach in New York rather than submit to the fingerprinting newly required of foreign visitors to the United States, and likened such biometric registration to the tattooing of deportees at Auschwitz. Many readers found the comparison excessive; the dispute itself shows how quickly the documentary regime calls up the memory of its worst precedents.

A second development sharpens the first. Synthetic media now make the image, the voice, and the tear itself forgeable at scale, and the living voice that unmade the Hughes hoax (§5.5) could today be fabricated. Sinon's art has been industrialized, and Kathy's bench automated. When tokens and tears alike can be manufactured, attestation migrates toward cost: toward the act its author pays for, of which the gift is the everyday form and the witness who suffers for testimony the extreme.

Theses

1. Every regime of identification is also a regime of feeling: it determines which tears may be shed, which are sold, and which are extracted.
2. Attestation is second-personal before it is documentary. A person exists in the common world first as one whose loss would be mourned.
3. Tokens and tears are alike forgeable. What distinguishes a true attestation is its direction, its cost, and its answer.
4. Every archive that governs must be shadowed by an archive that mourns.
5. The tear is a threshold of justice, never its substitute.

Envoi

Dowland's last stanza blesses the shadows that dwell in darkness and have learned to contemn light: "Happy, happy they that in hell / Feel not the world's despite." The regime's subjects are happy in that sense: the students who enter the camps of their own accord (§5.7), and Winston in the Chestnut Tree Café. *Flow My Tears* refuses Dowland's last consolation. Its final movement belongs to a man who feels the world's despite and turns his feeling into a gift. The policeman said, flow, my tears, and they flowed; and a stranger whose people the law had forbidden to increase took out the pictures of his children. That exchange, a drawn heart for three faces, is the first entry in the counter-archive and the novel's answer to the question with which it began: *fleo, ergo es*. I weep, therefore you are.

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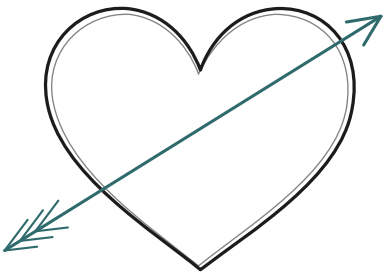
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Keywords

Philip K. Dick; *Flow My Tears, the Policeman Said*; John Dowland; *Lachrimae*; science fiction; philosophical fiction; anagnorisis; recognition; attestation; acknowledgment; documentary ontology; *esse est inscribi*; lacrimal anagnorisis; dacryology; counter-archive; tears; grief; mourning; compassion; sentimentality; kitsch; personhood; forensic person; identity documents; celebrity; surveillance; police state; state of exception; biopolitics; totalitarianism; *idios kosmos*; *koinos kosmos*; Gnosticism; *Hymn of the Pearl*; rigid designation; possible worlds; drugs and perception; incest; exogamy; the gift; Acts of the Apostles; Ethiopian eunuch; Psalm 56; second-person ontology; *fleo, ergo es*.



The figure on the cover is the falling fourth with which Dowland's *Lachrimae* (1604) begins, A, G, F, E, drawn as falling tears. The heart is Buckman's drawing.

Set in EB Garamond.